

unfoldingWord® Translation Notes © 2022 unfoldingWord. Released under CC BY-SA 4.0 license.
unfoldingWord® Translation Notes has been adapted in the following languages: Tok Pisin, Arabic (عربي), French (Français), Hindi (हिंदी), Indonesian (Bahasa Indonesia), Portuguese (Português), Russian (Русский), Spanish (Español), Swahili (Kiswahili), and Simplified Chinese (简体中文) from
unfoldingWord® Translation Notes © 2022 unfoldingWord. Released under CC BY-SA 4.0 license by
Mission Mutual

Amos

Amos - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of Amos

1. Amos introduced (1:1)
2. Yahweh judges the surrounding nations (1:2-2:3), the southern kingdom of Israel (2:4-5), and the northern kingdom (2:6-16)
3. Yahweh condemns Israel's injustice and religious hypocrisy (3-6)
4. Yahweh warns of coming judgment through visions (7:1-9:10)
5. Yahweh promises restoration and renewal for his people (9:11-15)

What is the Book of Amos about?

The Book of Amos contains the words of Amos, a shepherd from Tekoa. Amos began to prophesy about 760 BC. He spoke Yahweh's messages against God's people behaving wickedly. He spoke messages to both the southern kingdom of Judah and the northern kingdom of Israel.

Yahweh gave Amos prophecies of judgment (Chapters 1-6) to proclaim to the people.

Three visions of Yahweh coming to judge the people are in the last part of the book (7:1-9:10). A final vision promises that Yahweh will restore Israel (9:11-15). He will restore the "tent of David." This means a descendant of David would once again be king over Israel.

How should the title of this book be translated?

The traditional title of this book is "The Book of Amos" or just "Amos." Translators may also call it the "The Book of the Sayings of Amos."

Who wrote the Book of Amos?

The prophet Amos probably wrote this book. He lived in the southern kingdom of Judah. Amos came from a poor family. They grew sycamore trees (7:14-15) and were shepherds (1:1). Though Amos was not trained as a prophet, he knew and understood the law of Moses.

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

How is justice described in Amos?

Justice is an important theme in the Book of Amos. Justice means people treating others fairly according to the law of Yahweh. People in Israel were oppressing and taking advantage of poor people, orphans, and

widows. Amos explained that Yahweh would prefer that the people act justly rather than sacrifice to him. Truly obeying the law of Moses meant being just to other people.

What is a lawsuit?

Many cultures have a process for resolving disputes through the use of courts. These legal disputes are called lawsuits. Amos uses various legal terms. Part of the book presents events in a courtroom. The people are introduced, the problem is explained, the people are examined, witnesses speak, and a verdict is given.

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

What is the meaning of the term "Israel?"

The name "Israel" is used in many different ways in the Bible. Jacob was a son of Isaac. God changed Jacob's name to Israel. The descendants of Jacob became a nation also called Israel. Eventually, the nation of Israel split into two kingdoms. The northern kingdom was named Israel. The southern kingdom was named Judah. In Amos, "Israel" almost always refers to the northern kingdom of Israel.

Where do the various narratives begin and end?

The structure of the Book of Amos may make it difficult to understand where Amos ends one thought and begins another. It may be helpful to solve these issues with carefully divided lines or paragraphs.

Amos - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh announces judgment on the nations neighboring Israel.

1. Yahweh judges the nations for their violence and cruelty (3-5)
2. Yahweh judges the nations for their oppression and betrayal (6-10)
3. Yahweh judges the nations for their violence and hostility (11-15)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Oracles against the nations

Each oracle repeats a fixed formula: a messenger formula, the count of the transgressions, the nation's offense, and a sentence of fire on its fortresses. Translate these repeated phrases consistently.

Amos 1:1 (#1)

דְּבַר־יְיָ עַמְמוֹס

"The words of Amos"

Amos is using the phrase **The words of Amos** to introduce this book. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new account.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Amos 1:1 (#2)

מִתְקֹאָה

“from Tekoa”

“Tekoa” is the name of a town south of Jerusalem.

See: How to Translate Names

Amos 1:1 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר רָאָה הַזֶּה

“which he saw”

The implication is that Amos received this message from Yahweh in a vision. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [which he saw in a vision that Yahweh gave him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 1:1 (#4)

שְׁנַתַּיִם לִפְנֵי הָרָעָשׁ

“two years to the face of the earthquake”

Amos is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [two years before the earthquake]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:2 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to Amos. It may be helpful to clarify that this is how he introduces his message for your readers. Alternate translation: [This is what Amos said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:2 (#2)

יְהוָה מִצִּיּוֹן וּמִיְרוּשָׁלַם יִתְּנָן קוֹלָיו

“Yahweh roars from Zion, and from Jerusalem he gives his voice”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Yahweh roars from Zion, indeed, from Jerusalem he gives his voice]

See: Parallelism

Amos 1:2 (#3)

יְהוָה מִצִּיּוֹן יִשְׁאַג

“Yahweh roars from Zion”

Amos is speaking of Yahweh as if he were a lion that **roars**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh thunders loudly from Zion]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:2 (#4)

יִתְּנָן קוֹלָיו

“he gives his voice”

Amos is using **gives his voice** as a common expression of the culture to mean “thunders.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he thunders]

See: Idiom

Amos 1:2 (#5)

וְאֶבְלוּ נְאֻזֹת הָרֹעִים

“and the pastures of the shepherds mourn”

Amos is speaking of **the pastures** becoming dry and desolate as if they were living things that could **mourn**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the pastures of the shepherds become desolate]

See: Personification

Amos 1:2 (#6)

נְאֻזֹת הָרֹעִים

“the pastures of the shepherds”

Amos is using this possessive form to mean that **the pastures** are the places where **the shepherds** feed

their flocks. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the pastures where the shepherds feed their flocks]

See: Possession

Amos 1:2 (#7)

רִאשׁ הַכַּרְמֶל

“the head of Carmel”

Here, **the head** represents the top of the mountain called **Carmel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the summit of Carmel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:3 (#1)

עַל-שְׁלֹשָׁה פְּשָׁעַי דָּמָשֶׁק וְעַל-אַרְבָּעָה

“For three transgressions of Damascus, and for four”

Yahweh is using the formula **For three transgressions of ..., and for four** throughout this chapter as a traditional Hebrew poetic device meaning complete or overflowing guilt. It does not mean a literal count of four specific sins. The number three shows a full measure, and the fourth pushes past the limit to trigger God’s judgment. If this would not be clear to your readers, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Damascus has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:3 (#2)

דָּמָשֶׁק

“Damascus”

Here, **Damascus** represents the people who live in that city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Damascus]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:3 (#3)

אֶת-הַגִּלְעָד

“the Gilead”

Here, **the Gilead** represents “the people who live in that region.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain

language. Alternate translation: [the inhabitants of Gilead]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:3 (#4)

לֹא אֲשִׁיבֶנּוּ

“I will not turn it back”

The pronoun **it** refers to Yahweh’s decision to punish. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:3 (#5)

דוֹשְׁשִׁים & אֶת-הַגִּלְעָד

“their threshing the Gilead”

Yahweh is speaking of the way the people of Damascus attacked the people of Gilead as if they had been **threshing** them or crushing the grain they harvested. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their savagely crushing the people of Gilead]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:3 (#6)

בְּהִרְצוֹת הַבְּרֹזָל

“with the threshing sledges of iron”

The agricultural tools described here as **threshing sledges of iron** were heavy wooden boards studded with sharp iron points or stones dragged over grain to crush it. If your readers would not be familiar with what a threshing sledge is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [with threshing instruments made of iron]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 1:4 (#1)

וְאֶכְלָה אֲרָמָנוֹת בֶּן-הַדָּד

“and it will devour the citadels of Ben Hadad”

Yahweh is speaking of fire completely destroying Ben Hadad’s citadels as if it would **devour** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy the citadels of Ben Hadad]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:5 (#1)

וְשִׁבְרֵי בָרִיחַ דַּמָּשֶׁק

“And I will break the bar of Damascus”

Here, **the bar of Damascus** represents “the defenses of that city.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And I will destroy the defenses of Damascus]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:5 (#2)

וְהִכְרַתִּי

“and I will cut off”

Here Yahweh is speaking of removing rulers from power as if he **will cut off** the king from his kingdom, like a person would cut a branch off of a tree. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I will remove]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:5 (#3)

יוֹשֵׁב

“the seated {one}”

Here, **the seated one** represents “the king” or “the enthroned one.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the king]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:5 (#4)

וְתוֹמָמֶד שֵׁשֶׁבֶט

“and the one grasping the scepter”

Here, **the scepter** represents “royal authority.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the one holding royal authority]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:6 (#1)

עֲזָה

“Gaza”

Here, **Gaza** represents “the people who live in that city.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could

use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Gaza]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:6 (#2)

עַל-שְׁלֹשָׁה פְּשָׁעֵי עֲזָה וְעַל-אַרְבָּעָה

“For three transgressions of Gaza, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 1:3. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Gaza has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:6 (#3)

הַגְּלוֹתֶם גְּלוֹת שְׁלֵמָה

“their taking into exile a complete exile”

Yahweh is using the expression **taking into exile a complete exile** as a common expression of the culture to mean “deporting an entire population.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their deporting an entire population]

See: Idiom

Amos 1:6 (#4)

לֹא אָשִׁיבָנִי

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 1:3. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:6 (#5)

לְהַסְגִּיר

“to hand {them} over”

Yahweh is speaking of Gaza selling people to Edom as if they were objects and they could **hand them over**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to sell them] or [to deliver them]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:6 (#6)

לְאָדָם

“to Edom”

Yahweh is using the term **Edom** to represent the people of Edom. Alternate translation: [to the people who live in Edom]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:7 (#1)

וְאֶכְלָה אֶרְמְנֶיהָ

“and it will devour her citadels”

Yahweh is speaking of fire completely destroying Gaza’s citadels as if it would **devour** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy her citadels]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:8 (#1)

וְהִכְרַתִּי יוֹשְׁבֵי

“And I will cut off the seated {one}”

See how you translated this same phrase, “I will cut off the seated one,” in 1:5. Alternate translation: [and I will remove their king]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:8 (#2)

וְתוֹמַמְדוֹ שֹׁשְׁבֹט

“and the one grasping the scepter”

See how you translated these same phrase, “the one grasping the scepter” in 1:5. Alternate translation: [and the one who has royal authority]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:8 (#3)

וְהִשְׁבֵּבוֹתִי יָדַי עַל-עֲקֶרְיוֹן

“and I will turn back my hand against Ekron”

Here, **my hand** represents “my power to punish.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and I will turn my punishing power against Ekron]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:8 (#4)

עֲקֶרְיוֹן

“Ekron”

Here, **Ekron** represents the people of the city of Ekron. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Ekron]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:9 (#1)

עַל-שְׁלֹשָׁה פְּשָׁעֵי-צֹר וְעַל-אַרְבָּעָה

“For three transgressions of Tyre, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 1:3. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Tyre has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:9 (#2)

צֹר

“Tyre”

Here, **Tyre** represents “the people who live in that city.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Tyre]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:9 (#3)

לֹא אֲשִׁיבֵנּוּ

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 1:3. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:9 (#4)

בְּרִית אֲחֵים

“the covenant of brothers”

Yahweh is speaking of the people of Tyre and the people with whom they had made a treaty as if they were **brothers**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the covenant they had made as close allies]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:9 (#5)

הַסְגִּירוֹם גְּלוּיֹת שְׁלֵמָה

“their handing over a complete exile”

See how you translated the very similar phrase, “taking into exile a complete exile, to hand {them} over” in 1:6. Alternate translation: [their deporting an entire population]

See: Idiom

Amos 1:10 (#1)

וְאֶכְלָהּ אֶרְמִנֶיהָ

“and it will devour her citadels”

See how you translated the phrase **and it will devour her citadels** in 1:7. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy her citadels]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:11 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה פְּשָׁעֵי אֱדוֹם וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָה

“For three transgressions of Edom, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 1:3. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Edom has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:11 (#2)

אֱדוֹם

“Edom”

Edom is being used to represent the people of Edom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Edom]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:11 (#3)

לֹא אֲשִׁיבָנִי

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 1:3. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:11 (#4)

רָדַפּוּ

“his pursuing”

The pronoun **his** refers to Edom, and the pronouns that follow in this verse refer to Edom as well. It may

be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Edom’s pursuing]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:11 (#5)

אָחִיו

“his brother”

Yahweh is speaking of the people of Israel, who were descended from Esau who was the twin brother of Judah from whom the Edomites descended, as if they were Edom’s **brother**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his kinsmen, the Israelites,]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:11 (#6)

בְּחֶרֶב

“with the sword”

Here, **the sword** represents “warfare.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in warfare]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:11 (#7)

וַשְׁחַתֵּת רַחֲמָיו

“and he destroyed his compassions”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **compassions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and he refused to act compassionately]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 1:11 (#8)

וַיִּטְרֹף לְעַד־אָפּוֹ

“and his nose tore perpetually”

Yahweh is using **his nose tore perpetually** as a common expression of the culture to mean “he continued to be very angry.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he kept raging with fury] or [he continued to be extremely angry]

See: Idiom

Amos 1:12 (#1)

ואֶכְלֶלָה אֲרָמְנוֹת בֹּזְרָה

“and it will devour the citadels of Bozrah”

See how you translated the similar phrase **and it will devour her citadels** in 1:7. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy the citadels of Bozrah]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:13 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה פְּשָׁעַי בְּנִי־עַמּוֹן וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָה

“For three transgressions of the sons of Ammon, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 1:3. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things the sons of Ammon have done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:13 (#2)

בְּנֵי־עַמּוֹן

“the sons of Ammon”

Yahweh is speaking as if the Ammonites, who were the descendants of Ammon, were actually the **sons of Ammon**. Alternate translation: [the Ammonites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:13 (#3)

לֹא אָשִׁיבָנִי

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 1:3. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:14 (#1)

ואֶכְלֶלָה אֲרָמְנוֹתֶיהָ

“and it will devour her citadels”

See how you translated the phrase **and it will devour her citadels** in 1:7. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy her citadels]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:14 (#2)

בְּתַרוּעָהּ בְּיָוֶם מִלְחָמָהּ בְּסָעֵר בְּיָוֶם סוּפָה

“with a shout in the day of battle, with a tempest in the day of the whirlwind”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the enemy will come with a shout in the day of battle, it will come with a tempest in the day of the whirlwind]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 1:14 (#3)

בְּסָעֵר בְּיָוֶם סוּפָה

“with a tempest in the day of the whirlwind”

Yahweh is speaking of the violence with which the enemy army will attack as if it were **a tempest in the day of the whirlwind**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with overwhelming violence on that day of destruction]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:15 (#1)

הֵהָא וְשָׂרָיו יִחָדְדוּ

“he and his officials together”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [he and his officials will go into the exile together]

See: Ellipsis

Amos - Chapter 2 Introduction**Structure and Formatting**

Yahweh judges the nations and Israel for sin.

1. Yahweh judges Judah and the nations for rebellion (1–5)
2. Yahweh condemns Israel for injustice and oppression (6–8)
3. Yahweh reminds Israel of his faithfulness and announces judgment (9–16)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Prophets and Nazirites

Israel silenced the prophets Yahweh raised up and made the Nazirites break their vow.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“For three transgressions ... and for four”

This traditional Hebrew poetic device continues as in chapter 1 which means complete or overflowing guilt.

Amos 2:1 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה פְּשָׁעֵי מוֹאָב וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָה

“For three transgressions of Moab, and for four”

Yahweh is using the formula **For three transgressions of ..., and for four** throughout this chapter as a traditional Hebrew poetic device meaning complete or overflowing guilt. It does not mean a literal count of four specific sins. The number three shows a full measure, and the fourth pushes past the limit to trigger God’s judgment. If this would not be clear to your readers, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Moab has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 2:1 (#2)

מוֹאָב

“of Moab”

Here, **Moab** represents the people who live there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [of the people who live in Moab]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:1 (#3)

לֹא אֶשְׁׁכְּבֵנוּ

“I will not turn it back”

The pronoun **it** refers to Yahweh’s decision to punish. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:1 (#4)

עַל־שָׂרִפְתּוֹ

“because of his burning”

The pronoun **his** refers to Moab, that is, to the people of Moab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [because of Moab’s burning]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:1 (#5)

שָׂרִפְתּוֹ עֲצָמוֹת

“his burning the bones”

In this culture, to burn someone’s bones was a terrible insult to the person. It involved violating his grave, and the burning was thought to disturb the person’s peace in the afterlife. You could include this information in a footnote if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:1 (#6)

לִישִׁיד

“to lime”

By **to lime**, Yahweh means that the king of Edom’s bones were burned so completely that they turned to white ashes. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to white ashes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:2 (#1)

וְאֶכְלָה אֶרְמְנוֹת הַקִּרְיֹת

“and it will devour the citadels of Kerioth”

Yahweh is speaking of fire completely destroying the citadels in Moab’s capital city, Kerioth, as if it would **devour** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy the citadels of Kerioth]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:2 (#2)

וּמָמָת & מוֹאָב

“and Moab will die”

Moab represents the people of Moab. Alternate translation: [and the people who live in Moab will die]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:2 (#3)

בְּקִקְוֵל שׁוֹפָר

“with the sound of the shofar”

A **shofar** is a kind of horn, made from the horn of a ram, that people blew to give signals in battle. If your readers would not be familiar with what a shofar is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [with the blast of a signal horn]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 2:3 (#1)

והִכְרַתִּי שׁוֹפָרָא

“And I will cut off the judge”

Here Yahweh is speaking of removing this ruling judge of Moab as if he **will cut off** this ruler like a person would cut a branch off of a tree. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will remove the judge]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:3 (#2)

מִקְרָבָהּ

“from her midst”

The pronoun **her** refers to Moab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [from the midst of Moab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:4 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁהּ פְּשָׁעַי יְהוּדָה וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָהּ

“For three transgressions of Judah, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 2:1. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Judah has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 2:4 (#2)

יְהוּדָה

“of Judah”

Here, **Judah** represents the people who live in the kingdom of Judah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [of those who live in Judah]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:4 (#3)

לֹא אָשִׁיבָנִי

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 2:1. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:4 (#4)

אֶת־תּוֹרַת יְהוָה

“the law of Yahweh”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean the **law of Yahweh** since he himself gave it to the people of Judah. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the law that Yahweh commanded them]

See: Possession

Amos 2:4 (#5)

אֶת־תּוֹרַת יְהוָה וְחֻקֵּיוֹ לֹא שָׁמְרוּ

“the law of Yahweh, and they did not keep his statutes”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person as **Yahweh** and **his**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [my law, and they did not keep my statutes]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 2:4 (#6)

בְּיִהְיֵהֶם

“and their lies”

Yahweh is speaking of the false gods that the people of Judah worshiped as if they were **lies**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their idols]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:4 (#7)

וַיִּתְעוּבֵם

“led them astray”

Yahweh is speaking of their being deceived into disobeying God’s laws as if they were being physically **led**

to go the wrong way or **astray**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [deceived them]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:4 (#8)

אֲשֶׁר-הִלְכּוּ אֲבוֹתָם אַחֲרֵיהֶם

“which their fathers walked after them”

It might seem that the expression **which their fathers walked after them** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [which their fathers walked after]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Amos 2:4 (#9)

אֲשֶׁר

“which”

The pronoun **which** refers to the **lies**, or the false gods that Judah followed, that were mentioned in the previous line. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the false gods]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:4 (#10)

אֲבוֹתָם

“their fathers”

Here, **fathers** represents “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their forefathers]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:4 (#11)

הִלְכּוּ & אַחֲרֵיהֶם

“walked after them”

Yahweh is speaking of Judah’s devotion and service to idols as if they physically **walked after** them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [had faithfully served]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:5 (#1)

וְאֶכְלָהּ

“and it will devour”

Yahweh is speaking of fire completely destroying the citadels in the capital of Judah, Jerusalem, as if it would **devour** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy the citadels of Jerusalem]

Amos 2:6 (#1)

עַל-שְׁלֹשָׁה פְּשָׁעַי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְעַל-אַרְבָּעָה

“For three transgressions of Israel, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 2:1. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Israel has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 2:6 (#2)

יִשְׂרָאֵל

“of Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:6 (#3)

אֶמְרָה יְהוָה & לֹא אֲשִׁיבָנִי

“says Yahweh & I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 2:1. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:6 (#4)

צַדִּיק

“the righteous”

Yahweh is using the adjective **righteous** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those people who are righteous]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:6 (#5)

וְאֶבְיֹן

“and the needy”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. He means that people in Israel are also selling **the needy** for a pair of sandals. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and their selling the needy]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 2:6 (#6)

וְאֶבְיֹן

“and the needy”

Yahweh is using the adjective **needy** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and those people who are in need]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:6 (#7)

בְּעֶבְרִית נִעְלָם

“in exchange for a pair of sandals”

Yahweh assumes that readers will know that **a pair of sandals** would only cost a very small amount. This means that they sold needy people into slavery for a price as low as the price of a pair of sandals. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for as little as the price of a pair of sandals]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:7 (#1)

הַשֹּׁאֲפָיִם עַל-עַפְרָאֲרִיזָן בְּרִאשׁ דָּלָיִם

“the ones trampling on the head of the poor to the dust of the earth”

Here Yahweh is speaking of the people of Israel oppressing and mistreating the poor as if they were **trampling on the head of the poor to the dust of the earth**, crushing them underfoot into the ground. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [cruelly oppressing the poor as if they are crushing their heads into the dust]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:7 (#2)

וְדָרְדָּר עֲנוּיִם יִטָּו

“and they turn aside the way of the afflicted”

Yahweh is speaking of the denying justice to afflicted people as if they would **turn aside** from the **way** along which they should walk. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they deny justice to the afflicted]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:7 (#3)

וְאִישׁ וְאָבִיו יֵלְכוּ אֶל-הַנְּעָרָה

“and a man and his father go to the girl”

Yahweh is referring to sexual relations in a polite way by using the phrase **go to**. Depending on what is helpful for your readers, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [and a man and his father have sexual relations with the same girl]

See: Euphemism

Amos 2:7 (#4)

עֲנוּיִם

“the afflicted”

Yahweh is using the adjective **afflicted** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [afflicted people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:7 (#5)

אֶת-שֵׁם קֹדֶשִׁי

“the name of my holiness”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe a **name** that is characterized by **holiness**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [my holy name]

See: Possession

Amos 2:7 (#6)

אֶת־שְׁמִי קִדְשִׁי

“the name of my holiness”

Here, **the name of my holiness** represents Yahweh himself, who is holy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [me, Yahweh, who is holy]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:8 (#1)

בְּגָדִים תְּבָלִים

“garments taken in pledge”

The expression **taken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [garments that they took as pledges]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 2:8 (#2)

בְּבֵית אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

“in the house of their God”

Yahweh is speaking of the temple as if it were a **house** in which he lived. Alternate translation: [in the temple]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:8 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

“their God”

Yahweh is not using this possessive form **their God** to indicate that the Israelites possess or control Yahweh but rather to emphasize that Yahweh is the God that the Israelites worship. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the God whom they worship]

See: Possession

Amos 2:9 (#1)

וְאֶאֱנֹכִי הַשְׁמַדְתִּי

“But I, I destroyed”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I destroyed** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize

that the Israelites could not have destroyed the Amorites without him but rather, he was the one who did it. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [It was I who destroyed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:9 (#2)

אֶת־הָאֱמֹרִי

“the Amorite”

Yahweh is not referring to a specific **Amorite**. He means the Amorite people group in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Amorites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Amos 2:9 (#3)

מִפְּנֵיהֶם

“from their faces”

Yahweh is using **from their faces** as a common expression of the culture to mean “on behalf of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on their behalf]

See: Idiom

Amos 2:9 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר כְּגִבְהַ אֲרָזִים גְּבֻהָּ

“who like the height of cedars {was} his height”

The point of this comparison is that just as **cedars** are very tall, so the Amorite people were very tall. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [who was extremely tall, as cedar trees are]

See: Simile

Amos 2:9 (#5)

וְהָסֹס הָהוּא כְּאֵלוֹנִים

“and he {was} strong as the oaks”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the oaks** are very strong, so the Amorite people were very strong. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he was very strong, as oak trees are]

See: Simile

Amos 2:9 (#6)

פְּרִיָּו מִמַּמְעַל וְשִׁשְׁיָו מִתַּחַת

“his fruit from above and his roots from beneath”

Yahweh is continuing the comparison of the Amorites to trees and referring to all of the Amorite people by naming two extremes, **fruit from above** and **roots from beneath**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [them entirely, leaving no survivors]

See: Merism

Amos 2:10 (#1)

וְאַנְכִּי הֵעֵלֵיתִי אֶתְכֶם

“And I, I brought you up”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I brought** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he was the one who brought the people of Israel up from Egypt. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [It was I who brought you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:10 (#2)

הֵעֵלֵיתִי אֶתְכֶם

“I brought you up”

Even though Yahweh has been speaking about the people of Israel with third person pronouns, here he switches to speaking directly to them much more personally in the second person as **you**. This is a plural pronoun if your language marks that distinction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make that clear. Alternate translation: [I brought you Israelites up]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 2:11 (#1)

וְאֶקְרָא

“And I raised up”

Yahweh is speaking of choosing certain young men to become prophets and Nazirites as if they were objects that he would physically lift or **raise up** into a high position. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I chose]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:11 (#2)

מִבְּנֵיכֶם

“from your sons”

The word **your** is plural here and throughout this passage because Yahweh is addressing the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of You

Amos 2:11 (#3)

וּמִבְּחֹרֵיכֶם לְנָזִירִים

“and from your young men as Nazirites”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I raised up from your young men as Nazirites]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 2:11 (#4)

הֲאֵפֶּה אֵין־זֹאת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Is it not even so, sons of Israel”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize that what he has just said is true. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [This is surely so, sons of Israel!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 2:11 (#5)

נֹאם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos is interjecting the phrase **the declaration of Yahweh** to indicate that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh's authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 2:12 (#1)

וַתִּשְׁקְרוּ אֶת־הַנְּזִירִים יַיִן

“But you made the Nazirites drink wine”

Yahweh assumes that readers will know that a Nazirite would have vowed not to drink wine according to rules laid out in Numbers 6:2–4. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [But you made the Nazirites break their vows and drink wine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:12 (#2)

צִוִּיתֶםם לֹא־תִנְבְּאוּ

“you commanded, saying, ‘You shall not prophesy”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [you commanded them that they should not prophesy]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 2:12 (#3)

צִוִּיתֶםם לֹא־תִנְבְּאוּ

“you commanded, saying, ‘You shall not prophesy”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly since **commanded** already includes that information.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 2:13 (#1)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

Yahweh is using the term **Behold** to focus the Israelites’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Consequently]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 2:13 (#2)

מַעֲצִיק תַּחֲתִּיכֶם כַּאֲשֶׁר תַּעֲצִיק הַעֲגֹלָה הַמְלֵאָה לָהּ עֲמִיר

“am pressing down in your place, just as the cart presses down, the one that is full of sheaves for it”

The point of this comparison is that just as load of sheaves of grain is heavy and presses down a cart so it can barely move, so Yahweh will press down heavily on the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [am pressing down on you heavily so you cannot escape just as a cart is pressed down and cannot move when its load of sheaves is too heavy]

See: Simile

Amos 2:14 (#1)

וְאַבְבָּד מִנוֹסִים מִקָּלָה

“And retreat will perish from the swift”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **retreat**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And the swift will not be able to flee]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 2:14 (#2)

מִקָּלָה וְחוֹזֵק

“from the swift, and the strong”

Yahweh is using the adjectives **swift** and **strong** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with a equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [from the swift person and the strong person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:14 (#3)

וְגִבּוֹר

“and the mighty”

Yahweh is using the adjective **mighty** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and the mighty person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:15 (#1)

וְתַפְסֵשׁ הַקֶּלֶשֶׁת

“and the one grasping the bow”

Yahweh is not referring to a specific person described as **the one grasping the bow**. He means archers in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you

could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and archers]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Amos 2:15 (#2)

וְקַלְבֵּי בְּרִגְלָיו

“and the swift on his feet”

Yahweh is using the adjective **swift** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and the one who is swift on his feet]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:15 (#3)

וְרֹכְבֵי הַסּוּסִים

“and the one riding the horse”

Yahweh is not referring to a specific person described as **the one riding the horse**. He means horsemen in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and those riding horses]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Amos 2:16 (#1)

וְאִמְמִיץ לִבּוֹ

“And the strong of his heart”

Yahweh is using **the strong of his heart** as a common expression of the culture to mean “courageous.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the most courageous]

See: Idiom

Amos 2:16 (#2)

בְּגִבּוֹרִים

“among the mighty”

Yahweh is using the adjective **mighty** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [among the mighty warriors]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:16 (#3)

עָרְוֹם יִגָּנוּס

“naked he will flee”

In this context, **naked will he flee**, means that this mighty warrior ran away without any of his weapons and armor. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he will flee stripped of his weapons and armor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:16 (#4)

בְּיוֹם־הַהוּא

“in that day”

The phrase **in that day** refers to that time when Yahweh will punish them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the time when I punish you]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:16 (#5)

נֹאמֵי־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the phrase **the declaration of Yahweh** in 2:11.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh holds Israel accountable for rejecting him.

1. Yahweh declares Israel accountable because he chose them (1-2)
2. Yahweh warns of coming judgment and calls his people to listen (3-10)
3. Yahweh announces the destruction of Israel's wealth and false security (11-15)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The horns of the altar

These projections at the corners of an altar were grasped for refuge; cutting them off (verse 14) means there is no refuge.

Rhetorical questions

The prophet Amos uses a chain of rhetorical questions to illustrate that God's judgment on Israel is the

expected outcome. Just as everyday causes naturally produce predictable effects, Israel's persistent sin makes divine disaster an absolute certainty.

Amos 3:1 (#1)

עַל־יֶכְכֶּם בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“against you, sons of Israel”

Amos is speaking of the people of Israel as if they were the **sons** of their ancestor Israel. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against you Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 3:1 (#2)

כָּל־הַמִּשְׁפָּחָה

“all of the family”

Here, **all of the family** represents all of the descendants of those who were captive in Egypt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of you descendants of those]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:1 (#3)

אֲשֶׁנִּשְׂר הָעֲלִייתִי

“that I brought up”

Amos first refers to **Yahweh** and then he uses the first person **I** to describe what Yahweh had done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the second person throughout this verse as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 3:2 (#1)

הֲרַק אֶתְכֶּם יְדֻעָתִי

“Only you have I known”

The implication is that when Yahweh says that he has **known** Israel, he means that he chose this people to belong to him in a special covenant relationship. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Only you have I chosen to be in a covenant relationship with me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:2 (#2)

מִשְׁפָּחוֹת הָאֲדָמָה

“the families of the ground”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean the nations or people groups that live on the earth. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the people groups that live on the earth]

See: Possession

Amos 3:2 (#3)

אֵת כָּל־עֲוֹנוֹתֵיכֶם

“all of your iniquities”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **iniquities**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [everything you have done wrong]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 3:2 (#4)

אֶפְקֹד עֲלֵיכֶם

“I will visit upon you”

Yahweh is using **I will visit upon you** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I will punish you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will punish you for]

See: Idiom

Amos 3:3 (#1)

הֲיִלְכְּכוּ שְׁנַיִם יַחְדָּם בְּלֹתִי אִם־נִוָּעְדוּ

“Will two walk together, unless they have agreed”

Yahweh, through Amos, is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that two people do not travel together unless they have arranged to do so. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Certainly two will not walk together, unless they have agreed!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:3 (#2)

בְּלֹתִי אִם־נִוָּעְדוּ

“unless they have agreed”

The pronoun **they** refers to the two people who agreed to walk together. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [unless the two of them have agreed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:4 (#1)

הִישָׂאֵג אֲרִיָּהּ בַּיַּעַר וְטָטְרָה אֵינִן לָלוּ

“Will a lion roar in the forest when there is no prey for him”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that a lion would certainly only roar if it were attacking its prey to catch and eat. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [A lion never roars in the forest when there is no prey for him]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:4 (#2)

הִיָּתֵתֵן כִּפְפִיר קוֹלוֹ מִמַּעַנְתּוֹ בְּלִתִּי אִם־לֹכֵד

“Will a young lion give his voice from his den, unless he has caught {something}”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that a young lion growls in its den only when it has caught something. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [A young lion never gives his voice from his den unless he has caught something!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:5 (#1)

הִתְפַּל צְפוּרִי עַל־פֶּפֶחַ הָאֲרָץ וּמוֹקֵשׁ אֵינִן לָלֶה

“Will a bird fall into a snare {on} the ground when there is no trap for it”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that a bird is caught only when someone has set a trap for it. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [A bird will certainly not fall into a snare on the ground when there is no trap for it!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:5 (#2)

הִיַּעֲלֶה־פָּחַח מִן־הָהָאָדָמָה וְלֹכְכֹד לֹא יִלְכֹּד

“Will a snare spring up from the ground, when capturing, it will not capture”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that a trap springs up only when it has caught something. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [A snare will certainly not spring up from the ground unless it has something to capture!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:5 (#3)

וְלֹכְכֹד לֹא יִלְכֹּד

“when capturing, it will not capture”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [when it has nothing to capture]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 3:6 (#1)

אִם־יִתְקַעַע שׁוֹפָרִי בְּעֵיר וְעָם לֹא יִחַרְדּוּ

“Or a shofar is blown in a city, and the people do not tremble”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that people will be afraid when they hear a warning that an enemy is attacking. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Certainly the people will tremble when a shofar is blown in a city!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:6 (#2)

יִתְקַעַע שׁוֹפָרִי בְּעֵיר

“a shofar is blown in a city”

Yahweh assumes that readers will know that **a shofar is blown in a city** it is to warn the people of that city that enemies are attacking. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [an alarm is sounded in a city to warn of attacking enemies]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:6 (#3)

יִתְקַקֵּעַ שׁוֹפָרָרְ

“a shofar is blown”

The expression **a shofar is blown** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone blows a shofar]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:6 (#4)

שׁוֹפָרָרְ

“a shofar”

A **shofar** is a kind of horn that people made from the horn of a ram and blew as a signal. If your readers would not be familiar with what a shofar is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a warning horn]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 3:6 (#5)

תִּהְיֶה רָצָהּ בְּעֵיר וַיְהִי לָא עֲשֵׂה

“disaster happens in a city, and Yahweh has not done {it}”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that Yahweh can cause disasters to happen as punishment. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statements or as exclamations. Alternate translation: [when disaster happens in a city, it is Yahweh who has done it!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:6 (#6)

וַיְהִי לָא עֲשֵׂה

“and Yahweh has not done {it}”

Here and in the next couple of verses, it could be that: (1) Amos is speaking about Yahweh as modeled in the UST (end Yahweh’s quote at the end of verse 2) or (2) Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person throughout these verses. Alternate translation: [and I, Yahweh have not done it]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 3:6 (#7)

וַיְהִי לָא עֲשֵׂה

“and Yahweh has not done {it}”

The pronoun **it** refers to the disaster that happens in the city. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh has not caused that disaster]

See: Pronouns – When to Use Them

Amos 3:7 (#1)

לָא יַעֲשֶׂה & דְּבַר

“will not do a thing”

By **Lord Yahweh will not do a thing**, means Yahweh will not bring any judgment to those he has a covenant relationship with, without first telling his prophets who serve him so they can warn the people what will happen if they do not turn from their sinful acts. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [will not bring judgment]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:7 (#2)

אֲדַבֵּר יְהוָה

“the Lord Yahweh”

Here and in the next verse, it could be that: (1) Amos is speaking about Yahweh as modeled in the UST (end Yahweh’s quote at the end of verse 2) or (2) Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person throughout these verses. Alternate translation: [I, the Lord Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 3:7 (#3)

סוֹדְדוֹ

“his secret counsel”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean the secret plans that he himself has made. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the secret plans that he has made] or [the secret plans the I have made]

See: Possession

Amos 3:8 (#1)

אַרְיֵה שָׁאַג

“The lion has roared”

Yahweh is speaking of the message he’s giving to the people through Amos as if it were the roar of a **lion** that everyone who hears it must fear (see 1:2). Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has roared like a lion]

See: Metaphor

Amos 3:8 (#2)

מִמִּי לֹא יִירָא

“who will not fear”

Yahweh is using the question form to state emphatically that everyone who hears a lion roar will be afraid. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [surely it would make anyone afraid!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:8 (#3)

מִמִּי לֹא יִנָּבֵא

“who will not prophesy”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the fact that when Lord Yahweh has spoken to his prophet, that prophet must proclaim his message. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [surely the one who hears him is compelled to prophesy!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:9 (#1)

הַשְׁמִיעוּ

“Cause {people} to hear”

The implication is that the messengers are to make this proclamation to the people who live in **the citadels in Ashdod** and in **the citadels in the land of Egypt**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Proclaim to the people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:9 (#2)

הַשְׁמִיעוּ עַל-אַרְמְנוֹת בְּאַשְׁדּוֹד וְעַל-אַרְמְנוֹת

“Cause {people} to hear on the citadels in Ashdod, and on the citadels”

Here, **on the citadels** represents the rulers and other powerful people who live in those citadels. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Tell those who are Ashdod’s rulers and who rule]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:9 (#3)

וְאָמְרוּ הָאֲסָפוּ

“and say, ‘Be gathered”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and tell them to gather]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 3:9 (#4)

הָאֲסָפוּ

“Be gathered”

The expression **Be gathered** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Gather yourselves]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:9 (#5)

מְהוֹמָמֶת רְבוֹתָת בְּתוֹכָהּ

“the great uproars in her midst”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **uproars**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how greatly the people in her midst are rioting]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 3:9 (#6)

בְּתוֹכָהּ

“in her midst”

The pronoun **her** refers to the city of Samaria. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [in Samaria]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:9 (#7)

וְעֹשִׂי־קִיָּם בְּקִרְבָּהּ

“and the oppressed within her”

Yahweh is using the adjective **oppressed** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and the oppressed people within her]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 3:10 (#1)

וְלֹא־יָדְעוּ עֲשׂוֹת־נִכְחָהּ

“And they do not know to do right”

The pronoun **they** refers to the people who live in Samaria. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the inhabitants of Samaria do not know to do right]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:10 (#2)

נֹאמִים־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words, is interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** to emphasize that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 3:10 (#3)

הִקְמָם וְשִׁשָּׁד

“violence and destruction”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **violence** and **destruction**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what they have violently and destructively seized]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 3:10 (#4)

הִקְמָם וְשִׁשָּׁד

“violence and destruction”

Here, **violence and destruction** represents the wealth that was attained and stored up as a result of the nation’s acting violently and destructively toward others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [wealth gained through violence and destruction]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:11 (#1)

לִכְנֹן

“Therefore”

The word translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [Because they have done these things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 3:11 (#2)

צָרָר וְסִבְבִּיב הָאָרֶץ

“An adversary—and around the land”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [An adversary will come, and he will be all around the land]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 3:11 (#3)

צָרָר וְסִבְבִּיב הָאָרֶץ

“An adversary—and around the land”

The implication is that **An adversary** is an enemy army that will surround the land and attack its cities. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The army of the adversary will besiege the land on every side]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:11 (#4)

וְהוֹרֵד מִמְּךָ עֲזָתְךָ

“And he will bring down from you your strength”

The pronoun **he** refers to the adversary, and the pronoun **you** refers to the land of Israel around Samaria and the people who live there. It may be helpful to

clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And that adversary will bring down from you Israelites your strength]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:11 (#5)

והורגך ממדה עזיך

“And he will bring down from you your strength”

Here, **your strength** represents the fortifications that the people of Israel trusted to protect them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And he will bring down your strong defenses]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:11 (#6)

ונבזזו ארמנותיך

“and your citadels will be plundered”

The expression **be plundered** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The adversary would be the one doing this. Alternate translation: [and he will plunder your citadels]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:12 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁר־יִצְצִיל הָרֹעֶה מִפִּי הָאֶרֶץ שְׁתֵּנֵי כֶּרְעֵים אֹזֶן כְּדֹל־אֶזְזֹן כִּנֹּן יִנְצִלְלוּ בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“As the shepherd rescues from the mouth of the lion two legs or a piece of an ear, thus will the sons of Israel be rescued”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the shepherd** can save only **two legs or a piece of an ear** from a lion that has attacked a sheep, so only a small remnant of the people of Israel will survive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Just as the shepherd can recover only parts of a sheep from the mouth of the lion, so only a small remnant of the sons of Israel will be rescued]

See: Simile

Amos 3:12 (#2)

כִּנֹּן יִנְצִלְלוּ בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“thus will the sons of Israel be rescued”

The expression **be rescued** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [thus I will only be able to rescue a few of the sons of Israel]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:12 (#3)

בַּפֶּאֶת מִטָּה וּבִדְמִמֶּשֶׁק עֶרֶשׁ

“with a side of a bed and with a cover of a couch”

The implication is that these scraps of expensive furniture are all that will be left of the luxury that the people of Samaria now enjoy. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with only a broken-off side of a bed and a torn piece of a couch left of all their luxury]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:12 (#4)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

Here, **sons** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the sons of Israel** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as **Israel**. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 3:12 (#5)

וּבִדְמִמֶּשֶׁק עֶרֶשׁ

“and with a cover of a couch”

Scholars are not sure what the word translated as **cover** actually means. It could be: (1) an unknown piece of a couch, as in the UST, or (2) a type of cloth, such as the city of Damascus was known for at a later time. Alternate translation: [and on a damask of a couch] or (3) the word “Damascus,” although spelled a little differently than usual. Alternate translation: [and on a Damascus couch]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 3:13 (#1)

בְּבֵית יַעֲקֹב

“against the house of Jacob”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Jacob** means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [against the people descended from Jacob]

See: Metaphor

Amos 3:13 (#2)

נֹאמִים־אֶל־נְבִיִּי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵתִי הַצָּבָאוֹת

“the declaration of the Lord Yahweh, the God of Armies”

Amos is interjecting the phrase **the declaration of Yahweh** into what Yahweh is saying to emphasize that what is about to be said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 3:13 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵתִי הַצָּבָאוֹת

“the God of Armies”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean the God who commands the armies of angels. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [God, the commander of the angel armies]

See: Possession

Amos 3:14 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם

“in the day of”

Yahweh is using the term **in the day** to refer to at a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when the time comes for]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:14 (#2)

פֶּשַׁע־יִשְׂרָאֵל עָלָיו

“my visiting the transgressions of Israel upon him”

Yahweh is using **my visiting the transgressions of Israel upon him** as a common expression of the culture to mean “my punishing the people of Israel for their transgressions.” If this phrase does not have

that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my punishing Israel for their transgressions]

See: Idiom

Amos 3:14 (#3)

פֶּשַׁע־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the transgressions of Israel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgressions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for the wrong things that Israel did]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 3:14 (#4)

עָלָיו

“upon him”

The pronoun **him** refers to the nation of Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [upon that nation]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:14 (#5)

וּפָקַדְתִּי עָלָיו

“I will also visit upon”

Yahweh is using **I will also visit upon** as a common expression of the culture to mean “to come against” or “punish.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will also come against]

See: Idiom

Amos 3:14 (#6)

וְנִגְדְעוּ קַרְנוֹת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“and the horns of the altar will be cut off”

Here, **the horns of the altar** represents the protection that people superstitiously sought when they took hold of those horns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the horns of the altar that people grasped for safety will be cut off]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:14 (#7)

וְנִגְדְּעוּ קַרְנֵי הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“and the horns of the altar will be cut off”

The expression **will be cut off** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Yahweh is the one who would do this. Alternate translation: [and I will cut off the horns of the altar]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:14 (#8)

קַרְנֵי הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“the horns of the altar”

The top corners of the central altar at Bethel (and others) were shaped like bull horns. These horns were a symbol of the strength of the god that was worshiped there. The horns were considered the most sacred and powerful part of the altar. You could include this information in a footnote if it would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:14 (#9)

וְנָפְלוּ לָאָרֶץ

“and they will fall to the ground”

The pronoun **they** refers to the horns of the altar. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and those horns will fall to the ground]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:15 (#1)

בֵּית-הַחֹרֶף עַל-בֵּית הַקֶּיֶץ

“the winter house with the summer house”

Yahweh is referring to all of the houses of the wealthy people of Israel by naming two extremes, **the winter house** and **the summer house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of their many houses]

See: Merism

Amos 3:15 (#2)

בְּתֵי הַשֵּׁשׁ

“the houses of ivory”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe **houses** that are characterized by decorations of **ivory**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the houses decorated with ivory]

See: Possession

Amos 3:15 (#3)

וְסָפְּדוּ בְּתֵי יָבֵים

“and great houses will come to an end”

The implication is that these **great houses** are the large and costly homes that wealthy people had built for themselves. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the large, costly houses of the wealthy will come to an end]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:15 (#4)

נֹאם-יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated this same phrase, **the declaration of Yahweh**, in 3:10.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh calls Israel to repentance.

1. Yahweh condemns Israel's oppression and indulgence (1-3)
2. Israel refuses to return to Yahweh despite his warnings (4-11)
3. Yahweh warns Israel to prepare to meet him (12-13)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

“return” to Yahweh

Each disaster in verses 6-11 closes with the refrain “yet you did not return as far as me.” To “return” is to repent and come back to a right relationship with Yahweh.

Amos 4:1 (#1)

שְׁמַעְעוּ הַדֹּבָר הַזֶּה פָּרָוֹת הַבָּשָׁן

“Listen to this word, cows of Bashan”

Amos is speaking to the wealthy women of Samaria, whom he calls **cows of Bashan**, although he knows that they cannot hear him. He is doing this to show his listeners in a strong way how he feels about the way these women oppress the poor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words as if he were speaking directly to the people about these women. Alternate translation: [Hear this word about the cows of Bashan]

See: Apostrophe

Amos 4:1 (#2)

פָּרָוֹת הַבָּשָׁן

“cows of Bashan”

Amos is speaking of the wealthy women of Samaria as if they were **cows of Bashan**, that is, well-fed cattle grazing in rich pasture on the hillsides overlooking Samaria. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you well-fed, pampered women]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:1 (#3)

הַרְצִיצוֹת

“the ones crushing”

Amos is speaking of the cruel way that these wealthy women are mistreating the needy people as if they were cattle **crushing** them underfoot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones mistreating the needy]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:1 (#4)

דִּלְלִים

“the poor”

Amos is using the adjective **poor** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who are poor]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 4:1 (#5)

אֲבִיּוֹנִים

“the needy”

Amos is using the adjective **needy** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who are needy]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 4:1 (#6)

הָאֲמָרֹת לְאֲדֹנֵיהֶם

“the ones saying to their masters”

The implication is that the **masters** of these women are their husbands whom they should be serving. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the ones saying to their husbands]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 4:1 (#7)

לְאֲדֹנֵיהֶם הַבְּרִיאָה וְנִשְׁתָּה

“to their masters, “Bring, and let us drink”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [to their masters that they should bring them something to drink]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Amos 4:1 (#8)

הַבְּרִיאָה וְנִשְׁתָּה

“Bring, and let us drink”

The women are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Bring drinks to us]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 4:2 (#1)

נִשְׁבַּע אֲדֹנָי יְהוֹה בְּקֹדֶשׁוֹ

“The Lord Yahweh has sworn by his holiness”

Following the custom of the culture, the Lord Yahweh is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by something sacred, his own **holiness**. Use a natural way in your

language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [The Lord Yahweh has solemnly promised, as surely as he is holy]

See: Oath Formulas

Amos 4:2 (#2)

בְּקֹדֶשׁוֹ

“by his holiness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **holiness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [by his holy name]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 4:2 (#3)

בְּכִי הַנִּנָּה יָמַיִם

“that, behold, the days”

Amos did not always say who was speaking or who was being addressed. Here, it seems to be the beginning of what Yahweh said but the ULT shows it as Amos telling us what Yahweh said (no quote marks). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could mark this as a direct quote of Yahweh as in the UST.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:2 (#4)

בְּכִי הַנִּנָּה יָמַיִם

“that, behold, the days”

Yahweh is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and you should take notice that the days]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 4:2 (#5)

וְנִשְׁאָא אֶתְכֶם

“when he will lift you up”

The pronoun **he** refers to their enemies and **you** to the women of Samaria. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when your enemies will lift you women up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 4:2 (#6)

וְנִשְׁאָא אֶתְכֶם בְּצַנּוֹת וְאַחֲרֵיהֶן בְּסִירְרוֹת דִּוְגָה

“when he will lift you up with hooks, and the last of you with hooks of fishery”

Amos is speaking of the women being carried away as captives as if they were fish that someone catches **with hooks** or **hooks of fishery**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he will carry you away as captives, every last one of you, as easily as a fisherman uses hooks to catch fish]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:3 (#1)

אִשָּׁה

“a woman”

Amos is using the phrase **a woman** as a common expression of the culture to mean “each woman.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each woman]

See: Idiom

Amos 4:3 (#2)

בְּנִדְחָהּ

“in front of her”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [going out through the break in the wall that is in front of her]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 4:3 (#3)

נְאֻם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos is interjecting the phrase **the declaration of Yahweh** to indicate that what is being said comes with Yahweh’s authority.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:3 (#4)

וְהִשְׁלַכְתֶּם הָהָרְמוֹנָה

“and you will throw {yourselves} out toward Harmon”

The word translated as **toward Harmon** could be: (1) the name of a place that is now unknown. (2) a word that means “rule” or “dominion.” Alternate translation: [and you will cast away dominion] or [and you will let go of your rule]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 4:4 (#1)

בבֹּאֵי בֵּית-אֵל וּפְשַׁעְנוּ הַגִּלְגָּל הָרַבְּבוּ לְפִשְׁשָׁעַי

“Go to Bethel and transgress, to Gilgal and multiply to transgress”

Yahweh actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he is saying here and throughout the next verse. He is telling them that they are doing these rituals with the wrong motives and thus sinning. If a speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You should not go to Bethel and sin there, nor to Gilgal and sin even more]

See: Irony

Amos 4:4 (#2)

וּפְשַׁעְנוּ

“and transgress”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgress**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and go against Yahweh’s commands]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 4:4 (#3)

לְשָׁלֹשֶׁת יָמִים מִעֲשֵׂרְתֵיכֶם

“your tithes every three days”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and bring your tithes every three days]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 4:5 (#1)

וְקָטַטְר מִחֶמֶץ תֹּדֶה וְקִרְאֹי וְנִדְבָבוּ הַשְׁמִיעוּ

“And make a thank offering smoke from what is leavened, and call out freewill offerings; make {people} hear”

Yahweh actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he is saying here. If a

speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I take no pleasure when you make a thank offering from what is leavened, and loudly announce your freewill offerings]

See: Irony

Amos 4:5 (#2)

וְקָטַטְר מִחֶמֶץ תֹּדֶה

“And make a thank offering smoke from what is leavened”

Amos assumes that readers will know that Yahweh had forbidden any burning of bread that contains yeast as a sacrifice to him (Leviticus 2:11). You could include this information in a footnote if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 4:5 (#3)

וְקִרְאֹי וְנִדְבָבוּ

“and call out freewill offerings”

The phrase **call out freewill offerings** could mean: (1) that people were to publicly announce when they brought a gift to Yahweh. This would be against the purpose of these offerings which were to be given whenever someone wanted to give something to Yahweh, Alternate translation: [and announce that you are bringing a freewill offering] or (2) that people would be required to bring freewill offerings. This would be the opposite of the meaning of freewill offerings, but perhaps what the people were doing. Alternate translation: [and announce that I require freewill offerings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 4:5 (#4)

כִּי כֵן אָהַבְתֶּם בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“For thus you have loved, sons of Israel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could move this phrase to the beginning of verse 4, since **For thus you have loved** gives the reason for these instructions that Yahweh is giving the people that are contradictory to what he has actually commanded them to do. Alternate translation: [Since you so love to do these things, sons of Israel, go ahead to Bethel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 4:5 (#5)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“sons of Israel”

Amos is speaking as if the Israelites were actually the **sons** of the patriarch **Israel**, who was also known as Jacob. Alternate translation: [you people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:5 (#6)

נֹאֲמִים אֶדְבַּרְנִי יְהוָה

“the declaration of the Lord Yahweh”

See how you translated the very similar phrase “the declaration of Yahweh” in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:6 (#1)

וְגַם-אֲנִי נָתַתִּי לָכֶם

“And even I, I gave to you”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I gave** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he himself is the one who sent the famine. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [And even I myself gave to you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 4:6 (#2)

נָתַתִּי לָכֶם נְקִיּוֹן שִׁנַּיִם

“I gave to you cleanness of teeth”

Yahweh is using **cleanness of teeth** as a common expression of the culture to mean “famine,” since people who have nothing to eat do not dirty their teeth. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I caused you to have famine]

See: Idiom

Amos 4:6 (#3)

נְקִיּוֹן שִׁנַּיִם בְּכָל-עִירְיָכֶם וְחֶסֶר לֶחֶם בְּכָל מְקוֹמֵיכֶם

“cleanness of teeth in all your cities, and lack of bread in all your places”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way as in the UST. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [cleanness of teeth in all your cities, indeed I gave to you lack of bread in all your places]

See: Parallelism

Amos 4:6 (#4)

וְחֶסֶר לֶחֶם

“and lack of bread”

Yahweh is using one kind of food, **bread**, to mean food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and lack of any food]

See: Synecdoche

Amos 4:6 (#5)

וְלֹא-שָׁבַתְתֶּם עָדָי

“yet you did not return as far as me”

Yahweh is speaking of the people repenting and giving him their loyalty again as if they would **return** to him along a road they were traveling on. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [yet you did not repent and give me your full allegiance]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:6 (#6)

וְלֹא-שָׁבַתְתֶּם

“yet you did not return”

Yahweh uses the word **yet** here to indicate a contrast between the famine that he sent and the response that he expected from the people. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but in spite of that, you did not return]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Amos 4:6 (#7)

נֹאֲמִים-יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:7 (#1)

וְגַם אֲנִי מִנְּעָה מִכֶּם

“And also I, I withheld from you”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I withheld** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he himself is the one who sent the drought. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [And also I myself withheld from you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 4:7 (#2)

וְהִמְטַרְתִּי עַל־עֵיר אֶחָת וְעַל־עֵיר אֶחָת לֹא אֶמְטֵר חֲלָקָהּ
אֶחָת תִּמְטֵר וְחֲלָקָהּ

“And I made it rain on one city, and on one city I did not make it rain; one portion was rained on, and a portion”

Yahweh uses the word **and** here to indicate a contrast between the city on which he made it rain and the city on which he did not make it rain. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And I made it rain on one city, but on another city I did not make it rain; one portion was rained on, but another portion]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Amos 4:7 (#3)

חֲלָקָה אֶחָת תִּמְטֵר

“one portion was rained on”

The expression **was rained on** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I sent rain on one portion]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 4:7 (#4)

וְחֲלָקָה אֲשֶׁר־לֹא־תִמְטֵר עָלֶיהָ

“and a portion which it did not rain on it”

It might seem that the expression **a portion which it did not rain on it** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [and another portion that received no rain]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Amos 4:8 (#1)

וְנִעְטוּ שְׁתֵּים־עָרָיִם

“And two–three cities staggered”

Yahweh is using **two–three cities** as a common expression of the culture to mean a small but indefinite number of cities. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And a few cities staggered]

See: Idiom

Amos 4:8 (#2)

שְׁתֵּים־עָרָיִם

“two–three cities”

Here, **cities** represents the people living in the cities that were suffering from lack of water. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people from a few cities]

See: Metonymy

Amos 4:8 (#3)

וְלֹא־שָׁבַתְתֶּם עָדָי

“yet you did not return as far as me”

See how you translated this in 4:6.

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:8 (#4)

נְאֻם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:9 (#1)

הִכְנִיתִי אֶתְכֶם בְּשֹׁד־פֶּן וּבִירְקוֹן

“I struck you with blight and with mildew”

Yahweh is speaking of afflicting their crops with blight and mildew as if he had physically **struck** them with a blow. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I afflicted your crops with blight and mildew]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:9 (#2)

וְלֹא־שָׁבַתְתֶּם עֲדָדִי

“yet you did not return as far as me”

See how you translated this in 4:6.

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:9 (#3)

נְאֻם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:10 (#1)

דִּבְרֵי־כָּרֶרֶךְ בְּדֶגְדְּרֵךְ מִצְרָיִם

“a plague in the way of Egypt”

Yahweh is using **a plague in the way of Egypt** to mean a plague like the ones that he sent on the Egyptians. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a plague like the ones I sent on the Egyptians]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 4:10 (#2)

הִרְגֵּיתִי בַחֶרֶב בְּחַיֵּי־יְרֵכְכֶם

“I killed your young men with the sword”

Here, **the sword** represents “warfare.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I allowed your enemies to kill your young men in warfare]

See: Metonymy

Amos 4:10 (#3)

בְּאֵשׁ מִחֵיכֶם

“the stench of your camp”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be

complete. He means that Yahweh caused the stench of the corpses of those killed to rise from where the Israelites were camped. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the stench of the corpses in your camp]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 4:10 (#4)

וְלֹא־שָׁבַתְתֶּם עֲדָדִי

“yet you did not return as far as me”

See how you translated this in 4:6.

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:10 (#5)

נְאֻם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:11 (#1)

הִפְפַּכְתִּי בְכֶלְכֶם כַּמֶּהֱפַכְתִּי אֱלֹהִיםֶם אֶת־סֹדֶדֶם וְאֶת־עֲמֹרָה

“I overthrew among you as God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah”

The point of this comparison is that just as **God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah** so completely that nothing was left of them, so the destruction that Yahweh brought on the Israelites was devastating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [I brought devastating destruction among you, just as God so completely destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah that nothing was left of them]

See: Simile

Amos 4:11 (#2)

וְתִהְיֶיךָ כְּאֵדָד מִצָּצֵל מִשֻּׁרְפָּה

“and you were like a firebrand snatched from a burning”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a firebrand snatched from a burning** is charred and barely saved, so the Israelites who survived were rescued only barely and at great cost. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and some of you barely survived, as though you had been pulled out of a fire at the last moment]

See: Simile

Amos 4:11 (#3)

כאֲדוֹד מִצֵּצֵל

“like a firebrand snatched”

The expression **snatched from a burning** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [like a firebrand that someone snatched]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 4:11 (#4)

וְלֹא־שָׁבַתְתֶּם עֲדָדִי

“yet you did not return as far as me”

See how you translated this in 4:6.

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:11 (#5)

בְּאֵם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:12 (#1)

לִכְלֹן כִּכְּהָ אֲעֲשֶׂה־לָּדֹךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Therefore, thus I will do to you, Israel”

The word translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [Because you would not return to me, this is what I will do to you, Israel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 4:12 (#2)

לָדֹךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“to you, Israel”

Israel represents the people of Israel. Alternate translation: [to you Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Amos 4:12 (#3)

עֲקֹב כִּי־זָזָתָא אֲעֲשֶׂה־לָּדֹךְ הַכֹּפֹן לְקִרְאֹת־אֱלֹהֵי־דֹךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“for the reason that I will do this to you, prepare to meet your God, Israel”

The words translated as **for the reason that** indicate that what follows is a reason for the command that comes after it. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason. Alternate translation: [and since I will do this to you, prepare to meet your God, Israel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 4:12 (#4)

הַכֹּפֹן לְקִרְאֹת־אֱלֹהֵי־דֹךְ

“prepare to meet your God”

The word translated as **prepare** is an imperative, but it communicates a solemn warning rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a warning. Alternate translation: [be prepared to meet your God]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Amos 4:13 (#1)

כֹּלִי הִנֵּה

“For behold”

The word translated as **For** connects this description of Yahweh to what he has just said, that they should “prepare to meet” their God, and the word **behold** calls attention to what follows. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [In fact, you will need to prepare to meet your God by carefully considering that he is]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Amos 4:13 (#2)

וּמִגִּיד לָאָדָם מַה־שֵּׁחַחֹו

“and declaring to man what {is} his thought”

This could mean: (1) God declares to people their own inward thoughts and motivations, as in the UST. (2) God reveals to people what he, God, is thinking. Alternate translation: [and declaring to man God’s own plans]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 4:13 (#3)

מַה־שֵּׁחַחֹו

“what {is} his thought”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **thought**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what he is thinking]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 4:13 (#4)

עֲשֵׂה שִׁשְׁחָרָר עִפְפָּה

“making dawn darkness”

This could mean: (1) God makes everything from morning light to the darkness of night. Alternate translation: [making all times of light and darkness] or (2) God causes morning to become night. Alternate translation: [making dawn into darkness]

See: Merism

Amos 4:13 (#5)

וְלָרֶגֶד עַל־כַּבְּמֹתֵי אֲרָץ

“and treading on the high places of the earth”

Amos is speaking of Yahweh ruling over the whole earth as if he were **treading on the high places of the earth**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and ruling over the whole earth]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:13 (#6)

אֱלֹהֵי־צְבָאוֹת

“God of Armies”

Amos is using this possessive form to mean the God who commands the armies of heaven. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [God who commands the armies of heaven]

See: Possession

Amos 4:13 (#7)

שְׁמוֹ

“is} his name”

Amos is using the term **name** to represent who Yahweh is or to refer to the Yahweh’s reputation. Alternate translation: [this is who he is]

See: Metonymy

Amos - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Yahweh mourns Israel’s coming downfall (1–3)
2. Yahweh calls Israel to seek him and reject injustice (4–17)
3. Yahweh warns of the coming day of Yahweh (18–20)
4. Yahweh rejects empty worship and demands justice (21–27)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The gate

Elders decided legal cases at the city gate, so the wrongs in 5:10 and 5:12 are abuses of the courts.

The day of Yahweh

Israel expected this “day of Yahweh” to bring victory, but it will bring judgment.

Amos 5:1 (#1)

אֶת־הַדְּבָר הַזֶּה

“this word”

Here, **this word** represents “the message that Yahweh is giving through Amos.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [this message]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:1 (#2)

אֲנִכְלִי וְשִׂשְׂא עֲלֵיכֶם

“I am lifting up over you”

Amos is speaking as if the song of mourning that he is singing were a heavy object that he was **lifting up over** the people of Israel. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am singing about you]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:1 (#3)

קִינָה

“a lamentation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **lamentation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a mournful song]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:1 (#4)

בְּבֵית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“house of Israel”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [all you Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:2 (#1)

נָטְשָׁה עַל-אֲדָמָתָהּ

“She is forsaken on her land”

The expression **is forsaken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Her enemies have left her lying on her land]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 5:2 (#2)

נִפְלְהָהּ לֹא-תוֹסִיף קִלְוִים בְּתוֹלַלֵת יִשְׂרָאֵל

“She has fallen; she will not repeat to rise, the virgin Israel”

Amos is speaking of the nation of Israel being vulnerable as if it were a young **virgin** woman who **has fallen** down and who will never **rise** again. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The nation of Israel has been defeated; she will never regain her power]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:2 (#3)

נִפְלְהָהּ

“She has fallen”

The pronoun **She** refers to the nation of Israel, whom Amos names as **the virgin Israel** later in this verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [The nation of Israel has fallen]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:2 (#4)

אֵין מְרַיָּם

“there is no one raising her up”

Here Amos is speaking of there being no one to help Israel as if it were a woman who had physically “fallen” and no one is **raising her up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly or use a comparable expression. Alternate translation: [there is no one to help her recover]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:3 (#1)

הַעֲיֵר הַיִּצְאָתָא אֶלֶף

“The city going out a thousand”

Here, **The city** represents “the fighting men who march out from the city.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [A thousand fighting men marching out from a city]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:3 (#2)

הַיִּצְאָתָא אֶלֶף תִּשְׁאַאִיר מֵאַלְפָה

“going out a thousand will leave a hundred remaining”

Here, **a thousand** and **a hundred** represent groups of soldiers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as modeled in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:3 (#3)

לְבֵית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“for the house of Israel”

See how you translated these same phrases in 5:1.

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:3 (#4)

לְבֵית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“for the house of Israel”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to defend the people of Israel]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:4 (#1)

דְּרִשְׁוֹנִי וְהִיוּ

“Seek me and live”

Yahweh is speaking as if the people could **Seek** him, as though he were something lost that they could look for and find. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Devote yourselves to me and live]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:4 (#2)

לְבַב־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“to the house of Israel”

See how you translated the same phrase “house of Israel” in 5:1.

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:4 (#3)

דִּרְשׁוּנִי וְחִי

“Seek me and live”

The word translated as **Seek** is an imperative, but it communicates a condition rather than a command. If the imperative does not communicate a condition for your readers, then use a form in your language that communicates a condition. Alternate translation: [If you seek me, then you will live]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Amos 5:5 (#1)

וְאַל-תִּדְרָשׁוּ בֵּית-אֱלֹהִים וְהַגִּלְגָּל לֵאמֹר לֹא תַעֲבֹדוּ כִּי הַגִּלְגָּל גִּלְגָּל וְיִגְלָה וּבֵית-אֱלֹהִים יִהְיֶה לְאִוֶּן

“and do not seek Bethel, and do not go to Gilgal, and do not cross over to Beersheba; for Gilgal, going into exile, will go into exile, and Bethel will become iniquity”

Yahweh uses the word **and** here to indicate a contrast between seeking him and seeking the shrines at Bethel, Gilgal, and Beersheba. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but do not seek Bethel; instead of going to Gilgal or crossing over to Beersheba, remember that Gilgal will surely go into exile, and Bethel will become iniquity.]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Amos 5:5 (#2)

וְאַל-תִּדְרָשׁוּ בֵּית-אֱלֹהִים

“and do not seek Bethel”

Yahweh is speaking of devoting themselves and worshipping at Bethel as if the people could **seek** and find something that had been lost. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and do not devote yourselves to worshipping at Bethel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:5 (#3)

בֵּית-אֱלֹהִים

“Bethel”

Here, **Bethel** represents “the shrine at Bethel where the people worshiped.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the shrine at Bethel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:5 (#4)

הַגִּלְגָּל גִּלְגָּל יִגְלָה

“Gilgal, going into exile, will go into exile”

The words translated as **going into exile, will go into exile** sound like the name of the town, **Gilgal**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Amos 5:5 (#5)

גִּלְגָּל יִגְלָה

“going into exile, will go into exile”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **go into exile** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [for Gilgal will certainly go into exile]

See: Reduplication

Amos 5:5 (#6)

וּבֵית-אֱלֹהִים יִהְיֶה לְאִוֶּן

“and Bethel will become iniquity”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **iniquity**, you could express the same idea

in another way. Alternate translation: [and Bethel will become an evil place]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:5 (#7)

בֵּית־אֵל יִהְיֶה לְאִוֶּן

“and Bethel will become iniquity”

Here, **Bethel** represents “the worship that the people offer at Bethel.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the worship at Bethel will become iniquity]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:6 (#1)

דַּרְשׁוּ אֶת־יְהוָה וְחִיּוּ

“Seek Yahweh and live”

Amos is speaking as if the people could **Seek** Yahweh, as though he were something lost that they could look for and find. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Devote yourselves to Yahweh and live]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:6 (#2)

פֶּן־יִצְלֶחַ

“lest he break out”

Amos is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the people of Israel an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise, he will break out]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Amos 5:6 (#3)

פֶּן־יִצְלֶחַ כְּאֵשׁ בֵּית יוֹסֵף

“lest he break out like fire {in} the house of Joseph”

The point of this comparison is that just as **fire** spreads swiftly and destroys everything in its path, so Yahweh’s judgment will come swiftly and destroy the descendants of Joseph. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [lest he break out against the

house of Joseph like a fire that spreads swiftly and destroys everything in its path]

See: Simile

Amos 5:6 (#4)

בֵּית יוֹסֵף

“in} the house of Joseph”

Here the term **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Joseph** means all the people descended from the patriarch Joseph. By this time, those descendants had become the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh. Alternate translation: [among the descendants of Joseph] or [among the people of the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:6 (#5)

וְאֵכְלָה וְאֵין־מִכְבֵּד לְבֵית־אֵל

“and it consumes, and there is no extinguisher for Bethel”

is speaking as if Yahweh’s judgment against them were a **fire** that **consumes** them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and his judgment will destroy Bethel, and no one will be able to stop it]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:6 (#6)

וְאֵכְלָה

“and it consumes”

The pronoun **it** refers to the **fire** that Yahweh will send. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the fire consumes]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:7 (#1)

הַהֹפְכִים לְעֵצֵנָה מִשְׁפָּט

“the {ones} turning justice into wormwood”

Amos is speaking to those who have distorted justice as if **justice** were something that they could change into **wormwood**, a poisonous plant with a very bitter taste. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you

could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [those who have distorted justice for people]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:7 (#2)

הַהֹכְכִים לְלַעְנָה מִשְׁפָּט

“the {ones} turning justice into wormwood”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the ones turning what is just into something bitter]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:7 (#3)

וַיִּצְדֻקְהָ לְאַרְצָן הַנִּיחָו

“and they cast righteousness to the ground”

Amos is speaking of rejecting righteousness as if **righteousness** were an object that these people could **cast down to the ground** and leave there. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they completely reject righteousness]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:7 (#4)

וַיִּצְדֻקְהָ לְאַרְצָן הַנִּיחָו

“and they cast righteousness to the ground”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and they cast what is right to the ground]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:8 (#1)

עֹשֵׂה יוֹם כִּמְלֵחַ וְכֶסֶד לַיְלָה לְלִילָה הַחֹשֶׁךְ וְהַפֶּסֶד לַבֹּקֶר צֹלְמֹת יוֹם לַיְלָה הַחֹשֶׁךְ הַקּוֹרֵא לַמַּיִם הַיָּם וַיִּשְׁפֹּכֵם עַל-פְּנֵי הָאָרֶץ יְהוָה שְׁמוֹ

“The maker of the Pleiades and Orion, turning deep darkness into morning; he darkens day into night; calling for the waters of the sea, he pours them out on the face of the earth—Yahweh is his name”

Amos describes Yahweh as the one with power over all he created by a series of phrases and only names him at the end of the verse. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about who Yahweh is before the information about

what he does. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is the maker of the Pleiades and Orion, turning deep darkness into morning; he darkens day into night; calling for the waters of the sea, he pours them out on the face of the earth.]

See: Information Structure

Amos 5:8 (#2)

כִּמְלֵחַ וְכֶסֶד יִל

“the Pleiades and Orion”

The terms **Pleiades** and **Orion** are the names of groups of stars in the night sky. If your readers would not be familiar with what these are, you could use the names of star groups that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the groups of stars in the sky]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 5:8 (#3)

וְהַפֶּסֶד לַבֹּקֶר צֹלְמֹת יוֹם לַיְלָה הַחֹשֶׁךְ

“turning deep darkness into morning; he darkens day into night”

Amos is referring to all of time by naming the two major components, **morning** and **night**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [governing the passing of all time, from morning until night]

See: Merism

Amos 5:8 (#4)

עַל-פְּנֵי הָאָרֶץ

“on the face of the earth”

Amos is using **the face of the earth** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the surface of the earth.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everywhere on the earth]

See: Idiom

Amos 5:8 (#5)

יְהוָה שְׁמוֹ

“Yahweh is his name”

Amos is using the term **name** to represent who the Yahweh is or to refer to the Yahweh's reputation. Alternate translation: [This is Yahweh himself]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:9 (#1)

הַמְבַלְלִיג שֶׁנֶּשֶׁד עַל-עֵצָה

“the one making destruction flash against the strong”

Amos is speaking destroying the strong as if **destruction** were lightning that Yahweh could make **flash** suddenly against strong people. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one bringing sudden ruin upon the strong]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:9 (#2)

הַמְבַלְלִיג שֶׁנֶּשֶׁד עַל-עֵצָה וְשֶׁנֶּשֶׁד עַל & יְבוֹא

“the one making destruction flash against the strong, and destruction comes against”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **destruction**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the one suddenly destroying the strong, and he destroys]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:9 (#3)

עַל-עֵצָה

“against the strong”

Amos is using the adjective **strong** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [against those who are strong]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:10 (#1)

שֶׁנֶּאֱמָרוּ בְּשֹׁשֶׁר מוֹכֵרִי

“They hate the reprovener in the gate”

The pronoun **They** refers to the strong referred to in the previous verse, or those who are influential people of Israel whom Amos is condemning. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Those of you who are strong hate the reprovener in the gate]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:10 (#2)

בְּשֹׁשֶׁר מוֹכֵרִי

“the reprovener in the gate”

Here, **the gate** represents “the place where the leaders of a city decided legal cases.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the reprovener at the place of judgment]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:11 (#1)

יֵצֵן בּוֹשֶׁסְכָּם עַל-דָּדָל

“because of your trampling on the poor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **trampling**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because you trample on the poor]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:11 (#2)

כְּרִמֵּי-הַתֵּמָד

“vineyards of desire”

The implication is that these are **vineyards** that are pleasant and desirable. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [delightful vineyards]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:11 (#3)

בּוֹשֶׁסְכָּם עַל-דָּדָל

“of your trampling on the poor”

Amos is speaking those who are mistreating poor people as if these people were **trampling on the poor** beneath their feet. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are mistreating the poor]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:11 (#4)

דָּדָל

“the poor”

Amos is using the adjective **poor** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who are poor]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:12 (#1)

רַבִּימִים פִּשְׁעֵיכֶם וְעֲצָמִים הִטְאַחִיתֶם

“your transgressions {are} many, and your sins {are} mighty”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **transgressions** and **sins**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [that you have done many bad things and that you have sinned greatly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:12 (#2)

רַבִּימִים פִּשְׁעֵיכֶם וְעֲצָמִים הִטְאַחִיתֶם

“your transgressions {are} many, and your sins {are} mighty”

The terms **transgressions** and **sins** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [your sins are very many and very great]

See: Doublet

Amos 5:12 (#3)

צַדִּיקִין

“the righteous”

Yahweh is using the adjective **righteous** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [righteous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:12 (#4)

וְאַבְיֹנִים & הָטוֹ

“and they turn aside the needy”

Yahweh is speaking of those who deny justice to poor people as if they physically **turn aside the needy** so that they cannot reach the **gate**, the place where legal cases are decided. Your language may have a compa-

table expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they deny justice to the needy]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:12 (#5)

וְאַבְיֹנִים

“the needy”

Amos is using the adjective **needy** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [needy people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:12 (#6)

בַּשַּׁעַר

“in the gate”

Here, **the gate** represents “the place where the leaders of a city decided legal cases.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at the place where legal cases are decided]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:13 (#1)

הַמְשִׁכִּיל

“the prudent”

Amos is using the adjective **prudent** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who are wise]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:13 (#2)

יָדָם

“will be still”

The word translated as **will be still** could mean: (1) “will be quiet.” That is, prudent people will avoid criticizing people who do evil because doing so would be futile. Alternate translation: [will be silent] or (2) “will cease.” This would mean that prudent people will cease, that is, that there will be no more prudent people. Alternate translation: [will cease] or [will not be found]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 5:14 (#1)

דְּרִשׁוּ טוֹב וְאַל-רָע

“Seek good, and not evil”

Amos is speaking of trying to do something good or evil as if **good** and **evil** were objects someone would actually go search for or **seek**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Try to do what is good, and not what is evil]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:14 (#2)

כֵּן

“thus”

The word translated as **thus** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [as a result,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 5:14 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵי-צְבָאוֹת

“God of Armies”

Amos is using this possessive form to mean the God who commands the armies of heaven. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [God who commands the armies of heaven]

See: Possession

Amos 5:15 (#1)

וְהִצַּיְתוּ בְּשֹׁשֶׁר מִשְׁפָּט

“and establish justice in the gate”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and judge fairly in the gate]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:15 (#2)

וְהִצַּיְתוּ בְּשֹׁשֶׁר מִשְׁפָּט

“and establish justice in the gate”

Here, **the gate** represents “the place where the leaders of a city decided legal cases.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and establish justice in the place where the city leaders judge legal cases]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:15 (#3)

אִילָלִי & יְהוָה

“perhaps Yahweh”

This part of the verse introduces the possible consequence of fulfilling the condition proposed in the previous part. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the possible consequence of fulfilling this condition. Alternate translation: [if you do all those things, then perhaps, Yahweh]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Amos 5:15 (#4)

אֱלֹהֵי-צְבָאוֹת

“God of Armies”

See how you translated this same phrase, “God of Armies,” in 5:14.

See: Possession

Amos 5:15 (#5)

אִילָלִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי-צְבָאוֹת

“perhaps Yahweh, God of Armies, will be gracious”

Amos is presenting a possible situation, that Yahweh **will be gracious** to the survivors of the northern kingdom if the people hate evil, love good, and establish justice. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. Alternate translation: [if you do these things, then perhaps Yahweh, God of Armies, may be gracious]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Amos 5:15 (#6)

שְׂאֲרֵית יוֹסֵף

“to the remnant of Joseph”

Amos is using the possessive form to describe a **remnant** that is made up of the remaining descendants of **Joseph**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this

idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to those who survive among the descendants of Joseph]

See: Possession

Amos 5:16 (#1)

אֱלֹהֵי צְבָאוֹת

“God of Armies”

See how you translated this same phrase, “God of Armies,” in 5:14.

See: Possession

Amos 5:16 (#2)

הוֹ-הֵהוּ

“Alas! Alas”

Yahweh is describing people using a word, **Alas**, that expresses a strong feeling of dismay and distress. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Oh no! Oh no!] or [What a disaster!]

See: Exclamations

Amos 5:16 (#3)

וּמִסִּפְּטָד אֶל־יִיְדוּעֵי נָהִי

“and wailing to those knowing a lament”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context of the previous phrase if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they will call those knowing a lament to wailing]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:17 (#1)

אֶעֱבֹר בְּקִרְבְּךָ

“I will pass through your midst”

Yahweh assumes that readers would understand that the words **pass through** meant that he would be coming among them to punish them. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I will come among you and punish you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:17 (#2)

אֲמַמְרָ יְהוָה

“says Yahweh”

Amos is using the phrase **says Yahweh** to indicate that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 5:18 (#1)

הַקְוִי הַמִּתְאַוְּיִים

“Woe to the ones desiring”

Amos is using a phrase, **Woe to**, that expresses a strong feeling of grief and warning about coming disaster. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [How dreadful it will be for those desiring]

See: Exclamations

Amos 5:18 (#2)

אֶת־יְיָ יְהוָה

“the day of Yahweh”

Amos knows that his readers thought of **the day of Yahweh** as a time when Yahweh will come to bring justice but they thought it was to judge their enemies, not themselves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the time when Yahweh will come to bring justice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:18 (#3)

לְמַה־תִּנָּצַח לְכֶעֱכֶם יוֹם יְהוָה

“What {is} this to you, the day of Yahweh”

Amos is using the question form to rebuke his hearers for wanting **the day of Yahweh** to come. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The day of Yahweh will bring you no benefit!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 5:18 (#4)

הוּא־חֹשֶׁךְ וְלֹא־אֹר

“It {is} darkness and not light”

Amos is speaking as if disaster were **darkness** and deliverance were **light**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [It is a day of disaster and not of deliverance]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:18 (#5)

הוא־חֹשֶׁךְ וְלֹא־אֹר

“It {is} darkness and not light”

The pronoun **It** refers to **the day of Yahweh**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [That day is darkness and not light]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:19 (#1)

כְּאִשְׁשׁוּר יָנּוּס אִישׁ מִפְּנֵי הָאֵרֶץ

“As when a man flees from the face of the lion”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a man** who escapes one deadly danger runs straight into another, so the people of Israel will find no escape when Yahweh judges them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [You will be as unable to escape as a man who flees from the face of the lion]

See: Simile

Amos 5:19 (#2)

מִפְּנֵי הָאֵרֶץ

“from the face of the lion”

Here, **the face** represents “the presence.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the presence of the lion]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:19 (#3)

וּפְגַעְעוּ הַדִּבִּב

“and the bear meets him”

The pronoun **him** refers to the man who is fleeing from the lion. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the bear meets that man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:19 (#4)

וּבָרָא הַכְּבִית

“or goes into the house”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [or as when a man goes into the house]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:19 (#5)

וְסִמְמָה יָדוֹ עַל־הַקִּלְיָר וּנְשָׁכּוּ הַנָּחָשׁ

“and rests his hand on the wall, and the snake bites him”

The implication is that the man goes **into the house** in order to be safe, but that even there he meets deadly danger. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [rests his hand on the wall, thinking he is now safe, and the snake bites him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:20 (#1)

הֲלֹא־חֹשֶׁךְ יוֹם יְהוָה וְלֹא־אֹר וְאֶפְסָל וְלֹא־נִנְגָה לוֹ

“Is} not the day of Yahweh darkness, and not light? Even gloom, with no brightness in it”

Amos is using the question form to emphasize that **the day of Yahweh** will certainly bring disaster and nothing good. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The day of Yahweh is darkness, and not light, and gloom, with no brightness in it!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 5:20 (#2)

יוֹם יְהוָה

“the day of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18.

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:20 (#3)

חֹשֶׁךְ & וְלֹא־אֹר וְאֶפְסָל וְלֹא־נִנְגָה

“darkness, and not light? Even gloom, with no brightness”

Amos is speaking as if disaster were **darkness** and **gloom** and as if deliverance were **light** and **brightness**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [disaster, and not deliverance? Even sorrow, with no relief]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:20 (#4)

וְאֶפְסָל וְלֹא־נִנְיָהּ לוֹ

“Even gloom, with no brightness in it”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Is the day of Yahweh not even gloom, with no brightness in it]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:21 (#1)

שְׁנֵאתִי מֵאֲסֹתֵי חַגֵּיכֶם

“I hate, I reject your feasts”

This is the beginning of what Yahweh said. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could mark that this is a direct quote of Yahweh as in the UST.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 5:21 (#2)

שְׁנֵאתִי מֵאֲסֹתֵי

“I hate, I reject”

The terms **hate** and **reject** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [I reject with utter hatred]

See: Doublet

Amos 5:21 (#3)

וְלֹא־אֶרְיֵחַ בְּעֻצְרוֹתֵיכֶם

“and I will not smell in your assemblies”

Here, Yahweh uses **smell** to represent his accepting the pleasing aroma of the smoke that ascended from the burnt sacrifices. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and I will take no pleasure in the sacrifices you offer at your assemblies]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:22 (#1)

כִּי אִם־תַּעֲלוּ־לִי עֹלֹת

“For if you offer up to me burnt offerings”

Yahweh is presenting a possible situation, that the people might **offer up** to him **burnt offerings** and grain offerings. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. Alternate translation: [For suppose you offer up to me burnt offerings]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Amos 5:22 (#2)

וְשָׁשָׁלִם מִרֵּאֵיכֶם

“and the peace offering of your fattened animals”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe a **peace offering** that is made from **your fattened animals**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and the peace offering that you make from your fattened animals]

See: Possession

Amos 5:22 (#3)

לֹא־אֶבִּיט

“I will not look at”

Here, **look at** represents regarding something with favor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will not regard with favor]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:22 (#4)

לֹא־אֶבִּיט

“I will not look at”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I will not look at your peace offerings]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:23 (#1)

הַמִּמּוֹן שִׁירֵיד

“the noise of your songs”

Here, **your songs and the music of your harps** represent “the worship that you offer to me.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the noise of the worship you offer me]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:23 (#2)

לֹא אֶשְׁמָע

“I will not hear”

Here, **hear** represents “accept” or “pay attention to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will not accept as worship]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:24 (#1)

וַיִּגָּל כַּמַּיִם מִשְׁפָּט

“But let justice roll down like waters”

The point of this comparison is that just as **waters** flow abundantly and spread everywhere, so **justice** should be abundant and spread everywhere among the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [But let justice spread everywhere like waters]

See: Simile

Amos 5:24 (#2)

מִשְׁפָּט

“justice”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [people treating each other justly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:24 (#3)

וַיִּדְקָה כְּנַחַל אֵיתָן

“and righteousness like an ever-flowing stream”

The point of this comparison is that just as **an ever-flowing stream** never stops, so **righteousness** should be constantly among the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and righteousness flowing constantly like a stream that never stops]

See: Simile

Amos 5:24 (#4)

וַיִּדְקָה

“and righteousness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and doing what is right]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:25 (#1)

הֲזָבַחְתִּים וּמִנְחָהּ הַגִּשְׁתֶּם-לִּי בַּמִּדְבָּר אַרְבָּעֵים שָׁנָה

“Did you bring near to me sacrifices and a grain offering in the wilderness forty years”

Yahweh is using the question form to challenge the assumption of the people that sacrifices are all that he requires of them when actually, what he wants is their love and obedience. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You did not bring near to me sacrifices and grain offerings in the wilderness forty years, house of Israel.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 5:25 (#2)

הַגִּשְׁתֶּם-לִּי

“Did you bring near to me”

The pronoun **you** refers to the ancestors of the Israelites being addressed who lived during the years **in the wilderness**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Did your ancestors bring near to me]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:25 (#3)

בְּבֵית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“house of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:1.

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:26 (#1)

אֵאת סִכּוּת מַלְכְּכֶם וְאֵאת כִּיּוֹן צַלְמֵיכֶם כּוֹכַב לֵאלֹהֵיכֶם

“Sikkuth your king, and Kiyyun your images, the star of your gods”

Sikkuth and **Kiyyun** are the names of gods that the people of other nations worshiped that the Israelites also worshiped. If your readers would not be familiar with what these are, you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the statue of the god you called your king, and the image of another star-god you worshiped]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 5:26 (#2)

אֲשֶׁנָּשָׂר עֲשִׂיתֶם לָכֶם

“which you made for yourselves”

The pronoun **which** refers to the images of the gods that the people carried. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [which images of your gods you made for yourselves]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:26 (#3)

כּוֹכֵב לֵאלֹהֵיכֶם

“the star of your gods”

By **the star of your gods**, Yahweh is further clarifying that **Kiyyun** is the false god that they worshiped that is represented by a star. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the god that you worship that is represented by a star]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:27 (#1)

וְהִגְלִיתִי אֹתְכֶם

“So I will exile you”

The word translated as **So** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [Because you did those things, I will exile you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 5:27 (#2)

מִהַרְלָאָה לְדַמְשָׁק

“from farther than Damascus”

Yahweh assumes that readers would have known that **farther than Damascus** represented all the lands far to the north and east, where Assyria rules. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use

an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to the distant lands ruled by Assyria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:27 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵי צְבָאוֹת

“God of Armies”

See how you translated this same phrase, “Yahweh, God of Armies is his name” in 4:13. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, who is God of Armies]

See: Metonymy

Amos - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is a woe oracle against Israel’s complacent leaders (verses 1-7) and Yahweh’s sworn judgment (verses 8-14).

1. Yahweh warns the complacent and self-confident (1-7)
2. Yahweh rejects Israel’s pride and luxury (8-11)
3. Yahweh brings judgment on Israel for its injustice (12-14)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Woe

A woe oracle announces coming disaster in the tone of a funeral lament.

Oath

In verse 8 Yahweh swears by his own soul, since there is no one greater.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Chains of participles

The dashes in verses 3-6 and 13 mark phrases describing the people of verse 1.

Amos 6:1 (#1)

הָיוּ הַשְּׂאֲנָנִים בְּצִיּוֹן וְהַבְטָחָה בְּהַר שְׁמֶרֶן

“Woe to the ones at ease in Zion, and {to} the ones trusting in the mountain of Samaria”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Woe to the ones who feel completely secure in Zion and in Samaria]

See: Parallelism

Amos 6:1 (#2)

הָהוּי

“Woe to”

Amos is using the word **Woe** to express a strong feeling of grief and to warn of coming disaster. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Great disaster will come upon]

See: Exclamations

Amos 6:1 (#3)

בְּהַר שָׁמְרָא

“in the mountain of Samaria”

Here, **the mountain of Samaria** refers to the fortified capital city that was built on that mountain, and so it represents the security that its leaders believed they had. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the defenses of the city of Samaria to keep them safe]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:1 (#4)

רִאשֵׁיטֵּי הַגּוֹיִם

“the first of the nations”

The implication of the phrase **the first of the nations** is that these leaders regarded Israel as the elite of all the nations. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the nation that they consider foremost among all nations]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 6:1 (#5)

לָהֶם

“to them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the complacent leaders in Zion and Samaria whom Amos has just described. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to these leaders]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 6:1 (#6)

בְּבֵית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the house of Israel”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the nation of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:2 (#1)

הַטּוֹבִים מִן־הַמְּמַלְכוֹת הָאֵלֶּה

“Are} they better than these kingdoms”

The kingdoms of Judah (represented by Zion) and Israel (represented by Samaria) are being compared to the kingdoms represented by the cities named in this verse. Because of the parallel structure of the two questions in this verse, it is most likely that **they** refers to the cities that have just been named, and that **these kingdoms** refers to Judah and Israel. Alternate translation: [Are those cities better than your kingdoms]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 6:2 (#2)

הַטּוֹבִים מִן־הַמְּמַלְכוֹת הָאֵלֶּה אִם־רָב גְּבוּלָם מִגְּבֻלְכֶּם

“Are} they better than these kingdoms? Or {is} their border greater than your border”

The expected answer to these questions is “No.” The speaker is using the question form to emphasize that Judah and Israel are **better** in the sense that they are larger and more prosperous than the nations around them. It is possible that Amos is quoting these words from the “designated ones” who are boasting about their kingdoms. But since he refers to **your border**, it seems more likely that Amos is speaking to the “designated ones” and pointing out that, although God has made their kingdoms great, he will also destroy them because they are not better in the way that they should be. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as exclamations or as statements, as in the UST.

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 6:3 (#1)

הַמְּנַדְדִּים לַיּוֹם רָרָע וְתַגִּישׁוּן

“the ones putting far off the evil day, but you bring near”

Amos begins by speaking about these people in the third person as **the ones putting**, and then he addresses them directly in the second person with **you bring near**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the second person throughout. Alternate translation: [you who put far off the evil day, but bring near]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 6:3 (#2)

הַמְנַדְדִּים לַיּוֹם הַרָעָה

“the ones putting far off the evil day”

This phrase resumes the description of the people whom Amos pronounced disaster or “woe” upon in 6:1, and that description continues through verse 6. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to repeat the statement about the woe together with the information about these people and beginning a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Woe to you! You put far off the evil day]

See: Information Structure

Amos 6:3 (#3)

הַמְנַדְדִּים לַיּוֹם הַרָעָה

“the ones putting far off the evil day”

Amos is speaking of these people refusing to think about the coming day of judgment as if that day were an object that they were **putting far off**, or physically pushing away from themselves. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones pushing away the thought of the evil day] or [the ones refusing to think about the coming day of disaster]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:3 (#4)

לַיּוֹם הַרָעָה

“the evil day”

Here, Amos is referring to “the day of Yahweh” mentioned in 5:18 as **the evil day** since it was the time when Yahweh will bring justice by punishing them. Alternate translation: [the day of disaster that Yahweh will bring]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 6:3 (#5)

וְהַגִּישׁוּךְ

“but you bring near”

Here Amos is speaking hastening the coming time of violent rule as if that time were an object that could be **brought** physically **near**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but you are hastening the arrival of a time of violence] or [but you are making the time when violent people will rule come sooner]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:3 (#6)

שֹׁמְרֵת הַקִּמָּה

“a seat of violence”

Here, **a seat of** represents “a throne” or “a reign of.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [a reign of violence]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:3 (#7)

שֹׁמְרֵת הַקִּמָּה

“a seat of violence”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **violence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a violent rule]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:4 (#1)

מִטּוֹת שֵׁשֶׁן

“beds of ivory”

Amos is using the possessive form to describe **beds** that are inlaid with **ivory**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [beds decorated with ivory]

See: Possession

Amos 6:4 (#2)

וְעִגְלִים מִתּוֹךְ מֶרְבֶּקֶת

“and calves from the midst of the stall”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be com-

plete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and eating calves from the midst of the stall]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 6:5 (#1)

על־פִּי הַנְּגִינָה

“on the mouth of the harp”

Amos is using **on the mouth of the harp** as a common expression of the culture that means “to the sound of the harp.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the music of the harp]

See: Idiom

Amos 6:6 (#1)

וְרֵאשִׁית שְׁמֶנֶיךָ

“with the first of oils”

Amos is using **the first of oils** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the finest oils.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with the choicest oils]

See: Idiom

Amos 6:6 (#2)

שִׁשְׁכַּר יוֹסֵף

“the breaking of Joseph”

Amos is speaking as if the coming ruin of the nation were the **breaking** of an object. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the destruction that is coming upon the descendants of Joseph]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:6 (#3)

יוֹסֵף

“Joseph”

Here, **Joseph** represents the people of the northern kingdom of Israel, who were descended from his sons, Ephraim and Manasseh. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:7 (#1)

לְכֵן

“Therefore”

The term translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [As a result]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 6:7 (#2)

בְּרֵאשִׁית גְּלוּיִים

“at the head of the exiles”

Amos is using **at the head of the exiles** as a common expression of the culture to mean “first among those who are taken away into exile.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as the first ones to be taken away]

See: Idiom

Amos 6:7 (#3)

וְסֹסֶר מְרֻצָּח סְרוּחִים

“and the revelry of the sprawling ones will depart”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **revelry**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and the ones sprawling out will no longer celebrate loudly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:8 (#1)

נִשְׁבַּע אֲדֹנָיִי יְהוָה בְּנַפְשׁוֹ

“The Lord Yahweh has sworn by his soul”

Following the custom of the culture, Yahweh is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred, in this case by **his soul** or his own life, since there is no one greater by whom he could swear. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [The Lord Yahweh has taken an oath, swearing by his own life]

See: Oath Formulas

Amos 6:8 (#2)

אַת־גָּאֲאֹן יִצְקֶלֶב

“the pride of Jacob”

The **pride of Jacob** could refer to: (1) the land of Israel, which would include their strong cities and their luxuries that are mentioned here. See Psalm 47:4. Alternate translation: [this land that Jacob’s people are so proud of] or (2) the fact that the people of Jacob are so proud of themselves. Alternate translation: [that the people of Jacob are so proud]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:8 (#3)

בְּנַפְשׁוֹ

“by his soul”

Here, **his soul** represents Yahweh himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [by himself]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:8 (#4)

נֹאם־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי צְבָאוֹת

“the declaration of Yahweh, the God of Armies”

See how you translated the similar phrases, “the declaration of the Lord Yahweh, the God of Armies” in 3:13.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 6:8 (#5)

אַת־גָּאֲאֹן יִצְקֶלֶב

“the pride of Jacob”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **pride**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [this nation that Jacob’s people are so proud of]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:8 (#6)

יִצְקֶלֶב

“Jacob”

Here, **Jacob** represents the people of Israel, who were descended from him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or

plain language. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:8 (#7)

וּמְלֵאָה

“and its fullness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **fullness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and everything in it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:9 (#1)

וְהָיָה

“And it will happen”

Amos assumes that readers will know that what follows in these two verses are examples of the kinds of things that will happen when Yahweh punishes them. Use a natural way in your language to express examples of things that will happen.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 6:10 (#1)

וְנִשְׂאָאֻ דוֹדָדְךָ וּמִכְרַפְּךָ

“And his kinsman and the one burning him will lift him up”

The pronoun **his** refers to a man who has died in the house mentioned in the previous verse, and the pronoun **him** refers to that same dead man. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And a dead man’s kinsman, the one burning that dead man’s body, will lift him up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 6:10 (#2)

וּמִכְרַפְּךָ

“and the one burning him”

The implication is that this relative will burn the body of the man who has died rather than bury it, since so many people will have died that the usual custom of burial will not be possible. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the one who will cremate his body instead of burying it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 6:10 (#3)

להוציא עצמם

“to bring out the bones”

Here, **the bones** represents the dead body of the man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to bring out the corpse]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:10 (#4)

ואמור לאיש אשר ברכתי הבית העמוד עמוד ואמר אפס

“and he will say to the one who {is} in the innermost parts of the house, “Is there yet {anyone} with you?” and he will say, “None”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and he will ask the one who is in the innermost parts of the house whether anyone else is still there with him. That man will tell him that there is no one else in the house.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 6:10 (#5)

הח

“Hush”

The relative is using a word that expresses a strong feeling of alarm. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Silence]

See: Exclamations

Amos 6:10 (#6)

כפי ללא להזכיר בשם יהוה

“For not to make mention of the name of Yahweh”

The relative is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [For we are not allowed to make mention of the name of Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 6:11 (#1)

הבית הגדול וחסים והבית הקטן

“the great house into fragments, and the small house”

Amos is referring to all of the houses in the land by naming two extremes, **the great house** and **the small house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [every house]

See: Merism

Amos 6:11 (#2)

והבית הקטן בקעים

“and the small house into fissures”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will strike the small house into fissures]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 6:12 (#1)

הרצון בסלע סוסים אם יחרוש בקר

“Do horses run on the cliff? Or does one plow {it} with oxen”

Amos is using the question form to show that what the people of Israel have done is even more absurd than **horses** running or **oxen** plowing on a **cliff**. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Horses certainly do not run on the cliff! No one plows it with oxen!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 6:12 (#2)

הפכתם ראש משפט ופרגי צדקה ללעג

“you have turned justice into poisonweed, and the fruit of righteousness into wormwood”

Amos is speaking as if justice and righteousness were crops that these people had turned into the bitter and poisonous plants **poisonweed** and **wormwood**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you have made justice something deadly, and the results of right behavior something bitter]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:12 (#3)

הפכתם לראש משפט

“you have turned justice into poisonweed”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [you have turned judging people justly into poisonweed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:12 (#4)

לראש

“into poisonweed”

The term **poisonweed** refers to a kind of plant that is bitter and poisonous. If your readers would not be familiar with this plant is, you could use the name of a similar plant that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [into something bitter and poisonous]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 6:12 (#5)

ופרי צדקה ללצה

“and the fruit of righteousness into wormwood”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and you have turned the fruit of righteousness into bitter wormwood]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 6:12 (#6)

ופרי צדקה

“and the fruit of righteousness”

Amos is speaking of **righteousness** as if it were a plant that could bear **fruit**, meaning the good results that come from acting righteously. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the good results from acting righteously]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:12 (#7)

ללצה

“into wormwood”

The term **wormwood** refers to a kind of plant that has a very bitter taste. If your readers would not be familiar with what wormwood is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. See how you translated the similar phrase “turning justice into wormwood” in 5:17. Alternate translation: [into a bitter plant]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 6:13 (#1)

לללא דבר

“over Lo Debar”

Lo Debar is the name of a town. It means, “not a thing.” So although this was a real town that Israel had captured, Amos is also saying that they are rejoicing over nothing. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Amos 6:13 (#2)

הללא בהזקנו לקחנו לנו קרנ

“Have we not by our strength taken Karnaim for ourselves”

These people are using the question form to boast about their own strength. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Indeed, by our own strength we have taken Karnaim for ourselves!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 6:13 (#3)

קרנ

“Karnaim”

Karnaim is the name of a town. It means, “a pair of horns,” which is a symbol of strength. Amos is implying that just as the strength of Karnaim did not help them, neither should Israel trust in their own strength. Only Yahweh is truly strong. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Amos 6:13 (#4)

האמר ים הללא בהזקנו לקחנו לנו קרנ

“the ones saying, “Have we not by our strength taken Karnaïm for ourselves”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [the ones saying that by their strength they have taken Karnaïm for themselves]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 6:14 (#1)

הַנִּבִּיִּי מִקְלָיִם

“behold me raising up”

Yahweh is using **behold me** as a common expression of the culture to mean that the person is about to do something. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am about to raise up]

See: Idiom

Amos 6:14 (#2)

בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“house of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1.

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:14 (#3)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי הַצְבָּאוֹת

“the declaration of Yahweh, the God of Armies”

See how you translated the similar phrases, “the declaration of the Lord Yahweh, the God of Armies” in 3:13.

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Amos 6:14 (#4)

גִּגְיִי וְלֹחֲצִי אֶתְכֶם

“a nation, and they will oppress you”

In this verse, the word **nation** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the people of that nation as a group. That is why Yahweh then speaks of that nation with the plural pronoun **they**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural way to express this in your language. Alternate translation: [people of another nation will oppress you]

See: Collective Nouns

Amos 6:14 (#5)

מִלְכָּבֹּאֵי חֲמַת עַד־נִינְהַל הָעֲרָבָה

“from Lebo Hamath to the brook of the Arabah”

Yahweh is referring to all of that region by naming two extremes, **Lebo Hamath** in the far north and **the brook of the Arabah** in the far south. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [throughout the whole region]

See: Merism

Amos - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Three vision reports, each opening with the same formula, are followed by the narrative of Amaziah’s confrontation with Amos at Bethel (verses 10–17).

1. Yahweh shows mercy through Amos’s intercession (1–6)
2. Yahweh measures Israel’s faithfulness and announces judgment (7–9)
3. Amos faces opposition for proclaiming Yahweh’s word (10–17)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Prophetic intercession

Amos pleads for Israel after the first two visions and Yahweh relents; after the third vision he does not plead.

The royal sanctuary at Bethel

Bethel was the king’s own sanctuary, so Amaziah treats the message of Amos as a crime against Jeroboam.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Visions

Each vision repeats some form of this formula: “Thus the Lord Yahweh made me see, and behold....” Notice that in this context, “behold” quite literally means “and see” or “I saw that” since it is a vision that Yahweh is showing Amos. Translate these repeated phrases consistently.

Amos 7:1 (#1)

וְהִבֵּינָה

“And behold”

Amos is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language

may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [It was significant that]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 7:1 (#2)

אַחֲרֵי גִזְיֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“was} after the mowings of the king”

The phrase **after the mowings of the king** means that the king had the right to take the first cutting of hay from the fields for his own use, so the crop that the locusts were about to eat was all that was left for the people to use for themselves and their animals. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [after the king’s men had cut the first hay for him, so it was the crop the people needed for themselves and their animals]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:2 (#1)

בְּקֵהָהּ

“it had finished”

The pronoun **it** refers to the locust swarm mentioned in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the locust swarm had finished]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 7:2 (#2)

כִּי־יִקְרֹא יַעֲקֹב

“How will Jacob stand”

Amos is using the question form for emphasis, to express his conviction that the people of Jacob will not be able to survive such a disaster. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Jacob will surely not be able to stand!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 7:2 (#3)

יַעֲקֹב

“Jacob”

Here, Amos is using the name **Jacob** to refer to the people of Israel who were all descendants of the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an

equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the nation of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:2 (#4)

קָטָן

“small”

Amos is speaking of Jacob as if he were physically **small**. He means that the people of Jacob are weak and would be unable to survive this locust plague. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he is weak]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:3 (#1)

נִחַמְתִּים יְהוָה עַל־זָחָאֵת

“Yahweh relented concerning this”

The pronoun **this** refers to the destruction by locusts that Yahweh had shown Amos in the vision. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh relented concerning this locust plague]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 7:4 (#1)

וַתִּתְּאָכֶלֶת אֶת־תְּהוֹמוֹת רֶבֶבָה וְאָכְלָה אֶת־הַחֶלֶק

“And it devoured the great deep and was devouring the portion”

Amos is speaking of the fire as if it were a creature that **devoured** the waters and the land. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And it destroyed the great deep and was destroying the portion]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:4 (#2)

אֶת־תְּהוֹמוֹת רֶבֶבָה

“the great deep”

By **the great deep**, Amos means the ocean. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the ocean]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:4 (#3)

אֶת־הַחֶלֶק

“the portion”

The implication is that **the portion** is the land that Yahweh had assigned to the Israelites as their own share. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the land Yahweh had allotted to his people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:5 (#1)

מִמִּי יִקְרֹא יִצְקִיָּב כִּפִּי קִטְטָן הוּא

“How will Jacob stand? For he {is} small”

See how you translated these same phrases in verse 2.

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 7:6 (#1)

זֶה־זֶה

“this”

The pronoun **this** refers to the destruction by fire that Yahweh had shown Amos in the vision. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh relented concerning this judgment by fire]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 7:7 (#1)

אֲדַנְנִי נִצָּצָב עַל־חוֹמַמַת אֲנָבָד

“the Lord was standing beside a wall of a plumb line”

Here, **the Lord was standing beside a wall of a plumb line** represents Yahweh coming to examine his people to see whether they measure up to his standard, just as a builder examines a wall to see whether it is straight. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a footnote. Alternate translation: [the Lord was standing beside a wall to inspect it, ready to test his people against his standard]

See: Symbolic Language

Amos 7:7 (#2)

חֹמַמַת אֲנָבָד וּבִידָדוֹ אֲנָבָד

“a wall of a plumb line, and in his hand {was} a plumb line”

The word translated as **plumb line** could mean: (1) a plumb line, as in the ULT and UST or (2) a type of metal called “tin.” Alternate translation: [a tin wall and in his hand was tin]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 7:7 (#3)

חֹמַמַת אֲנָבָד

“a wall of a plumb line”

Amos is using the possessive form to describe a **wall** that is characterized by being made perfectly straight by using a **plumb line**, a builder’s tool made of a string with a heavy weight at the end that hangs straight down, used to check if a wall or structure is completely vertical. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a wall that had been made straight by using a plumb line]

See: Possession

Amos 7:8 (#1)

עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא־אֹסֶסְיָ עוֹד עֲבֹר לוֹ

“my people Israel. I will not again repeat to pass over him”

In this verse, the word **him** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the Israelites as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “him.” Alternate translation: [my people Israel. I will not again repeat to pass over them]

See: Collective Nouns

Amos 7:8 (#2)

אֲנָבָד & אֲנָבָד

“A plumb line & a plumb line”

As in verse 7, also in this verse the word translated as **plumb line** could mean: (1) a plumb line, as in the ULT and UST or (2) a type of metal called “tin.” Alternate translation: [Tin ... tin]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 7:8 (#3)

הִנְנִי שֹׁשֵׁם אֲנָבָד בְּקֶרֶבְבִּי עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Behold me placing a plumb line in the midst of my people Israel”

Yahweh holding a **plumb line** was a symbolic action by which he showed that he was going to measure his people’s behavior. If it would be helpful to your read-

ers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [Behold me setting a standard by which I will measure my people Israel]

See: Symbolic Action

Amos 7:8 (#4)

הַנִּנֵּי שְׁשָׁם

“Behold me placing”

Yahweh is using **Behold me** as a common expression of the culture to mean that he is about to do something. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am about to place]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:8 (#5)

לֹא־אֶסְפֹּף עֲדוּד עֲבֹדָה לּוֹ

“I will not again repeat to pass over him”

Yahweh is using **pass over** as a common expression of the culture to mean “overlook their sin.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will no longer forgive their sins]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:9 (#1)

וְנִשְׁשָׁמוּ בַּמִּזְבְּחִים וּמִקְדָּשֵׁי יִשְׂרָאֵל יִחָרְבוּ

“And the high places of Isaac will be deserted, and the sanctuaries of Israel will be desolate”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [And all the worship places of the Israelites will surely be left in ruins]

See: Parallelism

Amos 7:9 (#2)

וְנִשְׁשָׁמוּ בַּמִּזְבְּחִים וּמִקְדָּשֵׁי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And the high places of Isaac will be deserted”

The expression **will be deserted** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And I will destroy the high places of Isaac so they will be deserted]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 7:9 (#3)

בַּמִּזְבְּחֵי יִשְׁחָחֵק

“the high places of Isaac”

Here, **the high places** represent the shrines that the Israelites built on hilltops for worshiping idols. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the idolatrous places where the Israelites worshiped]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:9 (#4)

יִשְׁחָחֵק

“Isaac”

Here, **Isaac** represents all the people of Israel, as they were all descended from Isaac. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:9 (#5)

וְקָמַתִּי עָלָיו

“and I will rise against”

Here Yahweh is speaking of sending enemies to fight against them as if he would physically **rise**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will attack]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:9 (#6)

בֵּית יִרְבֹּעָם

“the house of Jeroboam”

Here, **the house of Jeroboam** represents “the royal family descended from Jeroboam.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the royal line of those descended from Jeroboam]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:9 (#7)

בְּחֶרֶב

“with the sword”

Here, **the sword** represents “warfare.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with warfare]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:10 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַח אֶמְצִיָּה בְּהֶהָן בֵּית־אֵאֵל אֶל־יִרְבֵּעֵם מֶלֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Then Amaziah, the priest of Bethel, sent to Jeroboam, king of Israel”

Amos is introducing **Amaziah, the priest of Bethel** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Amos 7:10 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁלַח אֶמְצִיָּה בְּהֶהָן בֵּית־אֵאֵל אֶל־יִרְבֵּעֵם

“Then Amaziah, the priest of Bethel, sent to Jeroboam”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Then Amaziah, the priest of Bethel, sent a message to Jeroboam]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 7:10 (#3)

בְּבֵית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the house of Israel”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:10 (#4)

לֹא־תוֹכֵל הָאָרֶץ לְהַכְבִּיל אֶת־כָּל־דְּבָרָיו

“The land is not able to contain all of his words”

Amaziah says **The land is not able to contain all of his words** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [The people of this land cannot endure everything he is saying]

See: Hyperbole

Amos 7:11 (#1)

כִּי־כֹהֵר אֶמְרָר עֲמֹוֹס בְּחֶרֶב יָמוּת יִרְבֵּעֵם

“For thus Amos says, ‘By the sword Jeroboam will die’”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [For Amos says that Jeroboam will die by the sword]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 7:11 (#2)

בְּחֶרֶב יָמוּת יִרְבֵּעֵם

“By the sword Jeroboam will die”

Here, **the sword** represents violent death in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Jeroboam will die violently in battle]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:11 (#3)

וַיִּשְׂרָאֵל

“and Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents the nation of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:11 (#4)

גָּלְלָהּ יִגְלָהּ

“going into exile, will go into exile”

Amos is repeating forms of the verb **go into exile** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have an-

other way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [will certainly be taken far away into exile]

See: Reduplication

Amos 7:12 (#1)

וְאִכְלֵם שָׁם לֶחֶם

“and eat bread there”

Amaziah is using **eat bread there** as a common expression of the culture to mean to earn what one needs to be able to eat. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and make your living there]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:12 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר אֶמְצִיחָהּ אֶל־עַמּוּס

“And Amaziah said to Amos”

Even though Amos has been speaking of himself in the first person as “I” and “me”, here he switches to speaking of himself in the third person as **Amos** to recount the exchange with Amaziah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person for consistency. Alternate translation: [And Amaziah said to me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 7:13 (#1)

וּבֵית־אֵל לֹא־תוֹסִיף עֲדוּד לְהַנְבִּיאַ כִּי מִקְדָּשׁ־מֶלֶךְ הָהוּא וּבָרִית מִמֶּלֶכָה הוּא

“But {at} Bethel you shall not repeat to prophesy again, for it {is} a sanctuary of the king, and it {is} a house of a kingdom”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But because it is a sanctuary of the king and it is a house of a kingdom, at Bethel you shall not repeat to prophesy again]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 7:13 (#2)

לֹא־תוֹסִיף עֲדוּד לְהַנְבִּיאַ

“you shall not repeat to prophesy again”

Amaziah is using **you shall not repeat to prophesy again** as a common expression of the culture to mean “you must not prophesy any more.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you must never prophesy any more]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:13 (#3)

וּבֵית מִמֶּלֶכָה הוּא

“and it {is} a house of a kingdom”

The implication is that by using the phrase **a house of a kingdom** which implies a royal temple, Amaziah is claiming that Bethel is a temple of the northern kingdom of Israel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and it is the royal temple of the northern kingdom of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:14 (#1)

וַיַּעַן עַמּוּס וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־אֶמְצִיחָהּ

“And Amos answered and said to Amaziah”

As in verse 12, Amos is speaking of himself in the third person as **Amos**. If you chose to translate it in the first person there, you should do so here as well. Alternate translation: [And I answered and said to Amaziah]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 7:14 (#2)

וַיַּעַן עַמּוּס וַיֹּאמֶר

“And Amos answered and said”

The terms **answered and said** together introduce a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent both terms explicitly as modeled in the UST.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 7:14 (#3)

לֹא־נָבִיא אֲנִי וְלֹא בֶן־נָבִיא אֲנִי כִּי־בֹקֶר אֲנִי

“I {am} not a prophet, and I {am} not a son of a prophet, for I {am} a herdsman”

Since this verse has no verbs in the original, this could mean: (1) that Amos is not currently a professional

prophet or part of a group of prophets but a herdsman, as modeled in the UST and UST or (2) that Amos was a herdsman and not a prophet before Yahweh called him to prophesy. Alternate translation: [I was not a prophet, and I was not a son of a prophet, for I was a herdsman]

Amos 7:14 (#4)

לֹא־נִבְּרִיא אֲנִי וְלֹא בֶן־נִבְּרִיא אֲנִי

“I {am} not a prophet, and I {am} not a son of a prophet”

Amos is using **a son of a prophet** as a common expression of the culture to mean “a disciple of a prophet.” He is making a point that he did not make his living as a prophet as those who were considered part of the official group of prophets did. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Idiom

Amos 7:14 (#5)

שִׁקְמִים

“sycamore figs”

The term **sycamore figs** describes a kind of fruit that grows on a large tree that was common in the warm, low-lying areas of that region. If your readers would not be familiar with what sycamore figs are, you could use the name of a similar fruit that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a kind of fig]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 7:15 (#1)

וַיִּקְחֵנִי יְהוָה מֵאַחֲרַי הַצֹּאֵן

“But Yahweh took me from after the flock”

Amos is using **took me from after the flock** as a common expression of the culture to mean “took me away from tending sheep.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But Yahweh took me away from my work of caring for the sheep]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:15 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלַי יְהוָה לֵלֶךְ הִנֵּבָא אֶל־עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and Yahweh said to me, ‘Go, prophesy to my people Israel’”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh told me to go prophesy to his people Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 7:16 (#1)

דְּבַר־יְהוָה

“the word of Yahweh”

Here, **the word of Yahweh** represents the message that Yahweh is speaking through Amos. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the message that Yahweh has for me to give you]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:16 (#2)

וְלֹא תִטְּרֶיךָ

“and you shall not drip”

Amaziah is speaking of prophesying or preaching as if it were words that **drip** from the prophet’s mouth, letting words fall like rain. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you shall not preach]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:16 (#3)

בְּבֵית יִשְׁחָק

“the house of Isaac”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Isaac** means all the people descended from the patriarch Isaac which is all the people of Israel. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:17 (#1)

אִשְׁתִּיךָ בְּעֵיר תִּזְנֶה

“Your wife will prostitute herself in the city”

The implication is that enemy soldiers will capture the city and force Amaziah's wife to become a prostitute. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Your wife will be forced to become a prostitute in the city when enemy soldiers capture it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:17 (#2)

ואדמתך בקחבל תחלק

“and your ground will be divided by the measuring line”

The expression **will be divided** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and enemies will divide your ground with the measuring line]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 7:17 (#3)

בקחבל

“by the measuring line”

Here, **the measuring line** represents “the parceling out of land to new owners,” since people used such a line to mark off the boundaries of property. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into parcels for new owners]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:17 (#4)

ואת־תִּנְיָה עַל־אֲדָמָתָהּ טִמְאָהָהּ תִּמְמֹת

“and you, you will die on unclean ground”

The implication is that **unclean ground** is a foreign land where people worship other gods, so that it is not a fit place for a worshiper of Yahweh to live. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and you, you will die in a foreign land that is defiled by the worship of other gods]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:17 (#5)

ואת־תִּנְיָה & תִּמְמֹת

“and you, you will die”

Amos is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you will die** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he is now address Amaziah's own fate. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [and you, yourself will die]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 7:17 (#6)

גָּלְיָה יִגְלָהּ

“going into exile, will go into exile”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:11.

See: Reduplication

Amos - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Yahweh announces the end of Israel (1–3)
2. Yahweh condemns Israel's greed and injustice (4–8)
3. Yahweh brings darkness and famine for his word (9–14)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The new moon and the Sabbath

Israelites did not trade on these holy days, so the merchants in verse 5 are impatient for them to end.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

A famine of Yahweh's words

In verses 11–13, hunger and thirst are used figuratively for Yahweh withholding his word.

Vision

This chapter begins with another vision. Be sure use language consistent with introducing the visions in the previous chapter, “Thus the Lord Yahweh made me see, and behold....” Notice that in this context, “behold” quite literally means “and see” or “I saw that” since it is a vision that Yahweh is showing Amos.

Amos 8:2 (#1)

קַיִץ

“summer fruit”

The word translated as **summer fruit** sounds very much like the word for **end**. Yahweh's purpose in showing Amos summer fruit was to give him a prophecy of

the end of his people. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:2 (#2)

לא־אֶסְסִיף עֲדוֹד עֲבֹר לִי

“I will not repeat again to pass over him”

See how you translated this same phrase in 7:8.

See: Idiom

Amos 8:3 (#1)

וְהִלְלִילוּ שִׁירֹת הַיְּכָלֹל

“And the songs of the temple will wail”

Here, **the songs of the temple** represents “the people who sing the songs in the temple.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the singers in the temple will wail]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:3 (#2)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“in that day”

The phrase **in that day** refers to that time when Yahweh will punish them, also referred to as “the day of Yahweh” in chapter 5. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the time when I punish you]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:3 (#3)

נֹאמָם אֶל־נְבִי יְהוָה

“the declaration of the Lord Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words here, is interjecting **the declaration of the Lord Yahweh** to emphasize that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 8:3 (#4)

הִס

“Hush”

Yahweh is using a word that expresses a strong feeling of dread. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Say nothing, for the dread is too great]

See: Exclamations

Amos 8:3 (#5)

הַשְּׁלִיךְ

“one has thrown {them}”

The pronoun **one** does not refer to any particular person. It refers to people in general. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [people have thrown]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 8:4 (#1)

הַשֹּׁמְרִים אֶת־יָגִוֹן

“the ones trampling the needy”

Amos is speaking of these people oppressing needy people as if they were **trampling** them underfoot. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones oppressing the needy]

See: Metaphor

Amos 8:4 (#2)

אֶת־יָגִוֹן

“the needy”

Amos is using the adjective **needy** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who are needy people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 8:4 (#3)

וְלִשְׁבֹּת עַוְיֹת־אֶרֶץ

“and to cause the afflicted of the land to cease”

By **cause the afflicted of the land to cease**, Amos means that they brought about the ruin of the poor because of their unfair treatment which **afflicted** them. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and bring to ruin the afflicted of the land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:4 (#4)

עניי־ארץ

“the afflicted of the land”

Amos is using the adjective **afflicted** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the afflicted people of the land]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 8:5 (#1)

מתאי יעבֹר החֹדֶשׁ שֶׁשָׁבִירָה וְהַשַּׁבָּת וְנִפְתָּחָה כֶּבֶד

“When will the new moon pass, that we may sell grain, and the Sabbath, that we may open wheat”

The implication is that the Israelites were not permitted to buy and sell on the festival of **the new moon** or on **the Sabbath**, and so these merchants were impatient for those days to end. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [When will the new moon festival, on which we are not allowed to trade, be over, so that we may sell grain, and when will the Sabbath, on which we are also forbidden to trade, be over, so that we may open our bins of wheat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:5 (#2)

לְהִקְטִין אֶפְהָה וּלְהַגְדִּיל שֶׁשֶּׁקֶל

“to make the ephah small and to make the shekel great”

The implication is that these merchants would measure out grain in a container smaller than a standard **ephah** and weigh their customers’ silver with a weight heavier than a standard **shekel**, so that they cheated the people who bought from them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to use an undersized ephah measure for grain and an oversized shekel weight for silver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:5 (#3)

מֵאֲזַנֵּי מִרְמָה

“balances of deceit”

Amos is using the possessive form to describe **balances** that are characterized by **deceit**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [deceitful balances]

See: Possession

Amos 8:6 (#1)

לְקַנְנֹת בְּכֶסֶף דְּלִילִים וְאֶבְיֹן בְּעֶבְרִיִּים נַעֲלָלִים

“to buy the poor with silver and the needy in exchange for a pair of sandals”

The merchants are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to buy the poor as slaves with silver and to buy the needy as slaves in exchange for a pair of sandals]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 8:6 (#2)

בְּכֶסֶף דְּלִילִים וְאֶבְיֹן

“the poor with silver and the needy”

The merchants are using the adjectives **poor** and **needy** as nouns to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [poor people with silver and needy people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 8:6 (#3)

וְאֶבְיֹן בְּעֶבְרִיִּים נַעֲלָלִים

“and the needy in exchange for a pair of sandals”

The implication is that **a pair of sandals** would only cost a very small amount. This means that they were buying needy people as slaves for a price as low as the price of a pair of sandals. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the needy for as little as the price of a pair of sandals]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:7 (#1)

בְּגִאֲזֹן יַעֲקֹב

“by the pride of Jacob”

As in 6:8, **the pride of Jacob** could refer to: (1) the land of Israel, since that is its meaning elsewhere, and it would make no sense to swear by something negative, such as sinful pride. Alternate translation: [by this land that Jacob's people are so proud of] or (2) Yahweh himself. This would then be equivalent to the phrase in 6:8, “The Lord Yahweh has sworn by his soul.” Alternate translation: [by himself, of whom Jacob's people are so proud]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:7 (#2)

יַעֲקֹב

“Jacob”

Here, **Jacob** represents the descendants of Jacob, the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Jacob's descendants]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:7 (#3)

אִם־אֲשַׁכַּח לִנְצַח כָּל־מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם

“If I ever forget all of their deeds”

Following the custom of the culture, Yahweh is swearing an oath by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”), which would be the penalty for not telling the truth. Normally the penalty would be understood to be something general such as “may Yahweh punish me severely,” yielding something like, “If I ever forget..., then may Yahweh punish me severely...” But since Yahweh is speaking, stating this would not make sense. It may be clearest to translate the oath as a positive statement, as in the UST.

See: Oath Formulas

Amos 8:8 (#1)

הַנֶּעַל זֹאתָ לֹא־תִרְגַּז הָאָרֶץ וְאִבְבֵּל כָּל־יֹשְׁבֵי בָבֶה

“Will not the land tremble over this, and everyone dwelling in it mourn”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize that the land will certainly tremble and that everyone living in it will certainly mourn. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The land will surely tremble over this, and everyone dwelling in it will mourn!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 8:8 (#2)

זֹאתָ

“this”

The pronoun **this** refers to the deeds of the people that Yahweh mentioned in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [will not the land tremble over the evil deeds that the people have done]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 8:8 (#3)

וְעֵלְתָהּ כָּאֶרֶץ כְּלִלָּה וְנִגְרָשְׁנָהּ וְנִשְׁקָה בִּיאָזוֹר מִצְרַיִם

“And all of it will rise like the Nile, and be cast up and sunk, like the Nile of Egypt”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the Nile of Egypt** rises in flood and then sinks back down again, so the whole land of Israel will heave up and down. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [And the whole land will heave upward and then settle back down, just as the Nile of Egypt rises in flood and then recedes]

See: Simile

Amos 8:9 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“in that day”

The phrase **in that day** refers to that time when Yahweh will punish them. See how you translated this same phrase in verse 3.

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:9 (#2)

נֹאמַם אֲדַבְּרִי

“the declaration of the Lord”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh's words here, is interjecting **the declaration of the Lord** to emphasize that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh's authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 8:9 (#3)

וְהִבֵּאתִי הַשֶּׁשֶׁשׁ בְּצִהְרֵי הַיּוֹם וְהִשְׁכַּחְתִּי לְאָרֶץ בַּיּוֹם אֵוֹר

“that I will make the sun set at noon, and I will darken the land in a day of light”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional as in the UST. Another approach would be to combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [that I will make the sunlight completely disappear in the middle of the day]

See: Parallelism

Amos 8:10 (#1)

וְהָעֲלִיתִי עַל-כָּל-מִתְנַנִּים שֶׁשָּׂק וְעַל-כָּל-רֹאשׁ קִרְחָה

“And I will bring up sackcloth on all loins, and baldness on every head”

Wearing **sackcloth** and shaving the head were a symbolic actions by which Yahweh’s people would show that they were mourning and grieving. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And I will cause everyone to put on sackcloth around their waists and to shave their heads bald to show their grief]

See: Symbolic Action

Amos 8:10 (#2)

וְשִׁמְתִּיהֶם בְּאֶבֶק יָחִיד וְאַחֲרֵיתָהּ כִּיּוֹם מָר

“And I will make it like the mourning for an only child, and its end like a bitter day”

The point of these comparisons is that just as the death of an **only child** brings parents the deepest possible grief, and just as **a bitter day** brings the greatest sorrow, so the people of Israel will grieve when Yahweh punishes them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [And I will cause you to grieve as deeply as parents who mourn the death of their only child, and everything will end in the most bitter sorrow]

See: Simile

Amos 8:11 (#1)

הַבִּנְיָה

“Behold”

Yahweh is using the term **Behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention, for]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 8:11 (#2)

נֹאכֶם אֶדְבָּרִי יְהוָה

“the declaration of the Lord Yahweh”

Amos is interjecting the phrase **the declaration of the Lord Yahweh** to indicate that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 8:11 (#3)

רָעָעַב בְּאַאֲרִיז לֹא-רָעָעַב לְלֶחֶם וְלֹא-צָמָא לַמַּיִם כִּכִּי אִם-לִשְׁמֹעַ אֶת דְּבַר־יְהוָה

“a famine in the land, not a famine for bread, and not a thirst for water, but rather to hear the words of Yahweh”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [it will not be a famine for food and it will not be a thirst for water, but rather I will send a thirst to hear the words of Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 8:12 (#1)

מֵיָם עַד-יָם וּמִצְפּוֹן וְעַד-מִזְרָח

“from sea to sea, and from the north and to the sunrise”

Yahweh is referring to all of the land by naming the extremes, **from sea to sea** and **from the north and to the sunrise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in every direction throughout the whole land]

See: Merism

Amos 8:12 (#2)

מִזְרָח

“the sunrise”

Here, **the sunrise** represents “east.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:13 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“In that day”

See how you translated the same phrase, “in that day,” in verse 3. Alternate translation: [At the time when I punish you]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:13 (#2)

תִּתְעַלְפֶּנָּה הַבְּתוּלֹת הַיְּפֹפּוֹת וְהַבְּחוּרִים

“the beautiful virgins will faint, and the young men”

Yahweh is using **the beautiful virgins** and **the young men**, to represent the strongest and healthiest of the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [even the strongest among the people, will faint]

See: Synecdoche

Amos 8:13 (#3)

וְהַבְּחוּרִים בְּצִמָּא

“and the young men, from thirst”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the young men will faint from thirst]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 8:14 (#1)

בְּאִשְׁמַמַּת שְׁמֶרֶוֹן

“by the guilt of Samaria”

Here, **the guilt of Samaria** represents the sin of idolatry practiced by the people there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [by the idolatry in Samaria that made the people guilty]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:14 (#2)

בְּאִשְׁמַמַּת שְׁמֶרֶוֹן

“by the guilt of Samaria”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **guilt**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [by what makes Samaria guilty]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 8:14 (#3)

וְאָמְרוּ חֲמִי אֱלֹהֵי־דָן וְחֲמִי דְדֶרֶךְ בְּאֶרֶץ־שֹׁשָׁבַע

“and they say, ‘By the life of your god, Dan!’ and, ‘By the life of the way of Beersheba’”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation as modeled in the UST.

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 8:14 (#4)

חֲמִי אֱלֹהֵי־דָן

“By the life of your god, Dan”

Following the custom of the culture, these people are swearing an oath by naming something that they hold sacred when they say **By the life of your god, Dan**. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [As surely as your god lives, Dan]

See: Oath Formulas

Amos 8:14 (#5)

וְחֲמִי דְדֶרֶךְ בְּאֶרֶץ־שֹׁשָׁבַע

“and, ‘By the life of the way of Beersheba’”

Here, **by the life of the way of Beersheba** represents the god that people traveled to worship at Beersheba. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and, ‘As surely as the god lives that people go on pilgrimage to worship at Beersheba]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:14 (#6)

וְנָפְלוּ וְלֹא־יִקְוִמוּ עוֹד

“and they will fall, and they will not rise again”

Yahweh is speaking of these people being destroyed with no hope of recovery as if they would **fall** down and never **rise** again. Your language may have a com-

parable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will be destroyed, and they will never recover]

See: Metaphor

Amos - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Yahweh brings judgment on Israel (1-6)
2. Yahweh judges Israel among the nations (7-10)
3. Yahweh restores David's fallen house and blesses his people (11-15)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The booth of David

The fallen booth of David in 9:11 pictures his ruined dynasty, which Yahweh will rebuild.

Amos 9:1 (#1)

רֹאֵאִיתִי אֶת־יְהוָה נֹצֵעַב עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“I saw the Lord standing by the altar”

Amos is using the words translated as **I saw the Lord standing by the altar** to introduce a new vision that Yahweh showed him. Use a word or phrase in your language to make that clear.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Amos 9:1 (#2)

הַכְּפֹתָאוֹר

“the capital”

A **capital** is the block of stone at the top of a column or pillar, on which the roof of a building rests. If your readers would not be familiar with what a capital is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the top of the temple columns]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 9:1 (#3)

וַיִּכְצְצֵם בְּרֹאשׁ כָּלֵלָם

“and cut them off on the head of all of them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the pillars and thresholds, while the phrase **all of them** refers to the people who are worshipping in the temple. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and

make the pieces of the pillars fall on the heads of all the worshipers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 9:1 (#4)

וְאַחֲרֵיהֶם

“and their end”

Here, **their end** represents all the rest of the people who were not killed by the collapse of the temple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and all who are left]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:1 (#5)

בְּהִתְרַב אֶהְרֹג

“I will kill with the sword”

Here, **the sword** represents warfare, that is, attack by an enemy army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will direct their enemies to kill them]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:1 (#6)

לֹא־יִנָּגֹס לָהֶם נָגֹס וְלֹא־יִמָּלֵט לָהֶם פְּלִיט

“A fleeing one will not flee for them, and a fugitive will not escape for them”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way as in the UST. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A fleeing one will not flee for them, indeed a fugitive will not escape for them]

See: Parallelism

Amos 9:2 (#1)

יְדִי תִקְחֵם

“my hand will take them”

Here, **my hand** represents the power of the Lord to act. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will powerfully take them]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:2 (#2)

אִם־יִחְתְּרוּ בְּשֶׂאֱזוּל מִשִּׁשָּׁם יָדָיו תִּקְחֶנָּם

“If they dig into Sheol, from there my hand will take them”

Here and in the next verse, Amos lists a series of an unreal, hypothetical situations that make the point that no matter where the people would try to hide themselves in order to escape Yahweh’s judgment, Yahweh will still find and punish them. Use a natural method in your language for introducing an imaginary situation. Alternate translation: [Even if they could dig way down into Sheol, from there my hand would take them]

See: Hypothetical Situations

Amos 9:3 (#1)

בְּרֹאשׁ הַכַּרְמֶל

“in the head of Carmel”

Here, **the head** represents the top of the mountain called **Carmel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at the summit of Carmel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:3 (#2)

וְאִם־יִסְתָּתְרוּ מִנֶּגֶד עֵינַי בְּקִרְקַע הַיָּם

“And if they are hidden from before my eyes in the floor of the sea”

The expression **are hidden** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And if they hide themselves from before my eyes in the floor of the sea]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 9:4 (#1)

וְאִם־יִלְכְּדוּ בְּשָׁבִי לִפְנֵי אֵיבֵיהֶם

“And if they go in captivity to the face of their enemies”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **captivity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And if their enemies capture them and carry them off]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 9:4 (#2)

לִפְנֵי אֵיבֵיהֶם

“to the face of their enemies”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of or in front of those enemies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of their enemies]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:4 (#3)

אֶצְוֶה אֶת־הַחֶרֶב וְהָרַגְתָּם

“I will command the sword and it will kill them”

Here, **the sword** represents the enemies who would use swords to kill them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will command their enemies and they will kill them]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:4 (#4)

וְשִׁמְתִּי עֵינַי עֲלֵיהֶם

“And I will set my eye on them”

The Lord is using **I will set my eye on them** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I will watch them closely,” usually in a positive sense of caring for them but here it is reversed in that it means he is watching them in order to harm them and not to help them. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will watch them closely]

See: Idiom

Amos 9:4 (#5)

לְרָעָה וְלֹא לְטוֹבָה

“for evil and not for good”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **evil** and **good**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [to punish them and not to benefit them]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 9:5 (#1)

ואדֹנֵי יְהוָה הַצְבָּאוֹת

“And the Lord Yahweh of Armies”

Amos is using the possessive form **the Lord Yahweh of Armies** to describe Yahweh as the one who commands the armies of heaven. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Lord Yahweh, who commands the armies of heaven]

See: Possession

Amos 9:5 (#2)

וְעִלְתָּה כִּיָּאֵר כְּלִלָּה וְשָׁקַעָה כִּיָּאֵר מִצְרַיִם

“and all of it goes up like the Nile, and it sinks like the Nile of Egypt”

See how you translated the very similar phrases in Amos 8:8.

See: Simile

Amos 9:6 (#1)

מַעֲלוֹתָיו

“his stairs”

The word translated as **stairs** represents the standard written Hebrew text as we have it today. Some scholars have proposed, however, that a scribe may have added an extra letter to this word. Without the extra letter, it would say “upper rooms,” which is how some modern versions translate. You may want to follow the major translation in your area. Alternate translation: [his upper rooms]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 9:6 (#2)

וְאִגְדָּתוֹ

“and his vault”

A **vault** is a kind of arched or domed roof. Amos uses the term to describe the sky as a dome stretched over the earth. If your readers would not be familiar with what a vault is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and the sky]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 9:6 (#3)

הַקִּרְיָא לְמִי־הַיָּם וַיִּשְׁפְּכֶם עַל־פְּנֵי הָאָרֶץ יְהוָה שְׁמוֹ

“the one calling to the waters of the sea, and he pours them out upon the face of the earth—Yahweh [is] his name”

See how you translated these very similar phrases in 5:8.

Amos 9:7 (#1)

הֲלֹא כִבְנֵי־כֻשִׁיִּים אַתֶּם לִּי בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Are you not like the sons of the Cushites to me, sons of Israel”

Yahweh is using the question form to insist that the Israelites are no longer more privileged in his sight than any of these other people groups because they have broken their special covenant with him. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You are just like the sons of the Cushites to me, sons of Israel!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 9:7 (#2)

כִּבְנֵי־כֻשִׁיִּים & לִי בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“like the sons of the Cushites to me, sons of Israel”

Yahweh is speaking as if the people of the nation of Cush, which is modern day Ethiopia, were actually **the sons** of Cush who was the son of Ham, and the people of Israel where the actual **sons** of the patriarch, Israel. Alternate translation: [like the Cushite people to me, you people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:7 (#3)

נֹאם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words, is interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** to emphasize that what is being said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 9:7 (#4)

הֲלֹא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל הָעֵלְיִיתִי מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם וּפְלִשְׁתִּיִּים מִכַּפְתָּרוֹ וְאֶרְבֵּם מִקִּיר

“Did I not bring Israel up from the land of Egypt, and the Philistines from Caphtor, and Aram from Kir”

Yahweh is using the question form to remind the Israelites that he is the one who controls where nations come and go just as he brought Israel out of Egypt. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Not only did I bring Israel up from the land of Egypt, but I also brought the Philistines from Caphtor, and the Arameans from Kir.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 9:8 (#1)

הִנֵּנִי

“Behold”

Amos is using the term **Behold** to focus his listeners' attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention!]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 9:8 (#2)

עֵינֵי יְהוָה אֲדַלְגֵּי יְהוָה בְּמַמְלַכְהָרָה הַחַטָּאָה

“the eyes of the Lord Yahweh are on the sinful kingdom”

Here, **the eyes of the Lord Yahweh** represents his watchful attention. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Lord Yahweh is watching the sinful kingdom closely]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:8 (#3)

אֲדַלְגֵּי יְהוָה

“the Lord Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person as **the Lord Yahweh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 9:8 (#4)

פָּנֵי הָאָדָמָה

“the face of the ground”

Yahweh is using **the face of the ground** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the surface of the earth” or “the whole earth.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the surface of the earth] or [the earth]

See: Idiom

Amos 9:8 (#5)

אֲנֹכֶם כִּי לֹא הַשְׁמַמִּיד אֲשַׁמְמִיד אֶת־בֵּית יַעֲקֹב

“Nevertheless, destroying, I will not destroy the house of Jacob”

Yahweh uses the word **Nevertheless** here to indicate a contrast between the destruction of the sinful northern kingdom and his promise to preserve a remnant from the descendants of Jacob. The fact that he will preserve a remnant is evident in the context of the next verse. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But destroying, I will not destroy the entire house of Jacob]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Amos 9:8 (#6)

לֹא הַשְׁמַמִּיד אֲשַׁמְמִיד

“destroying, I will not destroy”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **destroy** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I will certainly not completely destroy]

See: Reduplication

Amos 9:8 (#7)

נֹאמֵי־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh's words, is once again interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** to emphasize that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh's authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 9:8 (#8)

אֶת־בֵּית יַעֲקֹב

“the house of Jacob”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Jacob** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [all those descended from Jacob]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:9 (#1)

הִנֵּה

“behold”

Amos is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [surely you will see that]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 9:9 (#2)

אֶנְכִּי מְצַוֶּה

“I am commanding”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I am commanding that this happen]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 9:9 (#3)

וְהִנָּעֵתִי בְּכָל־הַגּוֹיִם אֶת־בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל כַּאֲשֶׁר יִנָּזַע בַּכְּבֵּרֶה

“and I will shake the house of Israel among all of the nations, just as it is shaken in the sieve”

The point of this comparison is that just as grain **is shaken in the sieve** in order to sort it, so Yahweh will shake **the house of Israel among all of the nations**, which included exile and dispersment among other nations, in order to separate the faithful people from the unfaithful ones. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and I will shake the house of Israel among all of the nations to separate the faithful from the unfaithful, just as grain is shaken in a sieve to separate it from stones]

See: Simile

Amos 9:9 (#4)

אֶת־בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the house of Israel”

Yahweh is speaking of all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel, as if they were one **house**. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:9 (#5)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יִנָּזַע בַּכְּבֵּרֶה

“just as it is shaken in the sieve”

The expression **is shaken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [just as someone shakes grain in a sieve]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 9:9 (#6)

בַּכְּבֵּרֶה

“in the sieve”

A **sieve** is a kind of container with holes in the bottom that a farmer shakes in order to separate grain from stones and dirt. If your readers would not be familiar with what a sieve is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [in a screen for sifting grain]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 9:9 (#7)

וְלֹא־יִפּוֹל צֶרֶדָּר אֶרֶץ

“and a pebble will not fall to the earth”

The meaning of the word translated as **pebble** could also be translated as “small grain,” and thus it is uncertain whether the grain stays in the sieve or passes through. In either case, the meaning of the comparison is the same; God is using the nations as a sieve to sort out the people of Israel into those who are faithful to him (the grain) and those who are not (the stones). You may want to choose how you translate this comparison depending on whether the grain in your area is bigger or smaller than the holes in a sieve. To summarize, this word could mean: (1) a small

stone. In this case, the sieve is retaining the stones and letting the grain fall through, as in the ULT and UST. (2) a small piece of something, such as grain. In this case, the sieve is retaining the grain and letting the small stones fall through. Alternate translation: [and a small grain will not fall to the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 9:10 (#1)

הַמְּרִיבִים לֹא־תִגָּיֵשׁ וְתִקְדְּדִים בְּעַד־יָדָיו הָרָעָה

“the ones saying, ‘The evil will not approach or reach as far as us’”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [the ones saying that the evil will not approach or reach as far as them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 9:10 (#2)

הַמְּרִיבִים לֹא־תִגָּיֵשׁ וְתִקְדְּדִים בְּעַד־יָדָיו הָרָעָה

“The evil will not approach or reach as far as us”

The sinners are speaking of suffering harm as if **The evil** were a living thing that could **approach** or **reach** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [We will not suffer any harm]

See: Personification

Amos 9:10 (#3)

הָרָעָה

“The evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Bad things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 9:11 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“In that day”

Yahweh is using the phrase translated as **In that day** to introduce a time of restoration. Unlike this phrase elsewhere in the book, it does not seem to indicate the time of punishment as in the “day of Yahweh” but the restoration that can occur because it is now possible.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Amos 9:11 (#2)

אֶקְוִים אֶת־סֹכֶכֶת דָּוִיד הַנִּפְסָלָה

“I will raise up the fallen booth of David”

Yahweh is speaking as if the dynasty or kingdom of David were a **booth**, a temporary shelter, that had collapsed and that he would restore or **raise up** again. He goes on to speak of repairing its **breaches** and rebuilding its **ruins**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will restore the fallen dynasty of David]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:11 (#3)

אֶת־פְּרִצֵּיהֶן

“their breaches”

The pronoun **their** probably refers to the cities of David’s kingdom. It may be clearer to use a singular pronoun to refer to the kingdom itself. Alternate translation: [its breaches]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 9:12 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־יִקְרָא שְׁמִי עֲלֵיהֶם

“whom my name is called over them”

Yahweh is using **my name is called over them** as a common expression of the culture to mean “they belong to me.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that belong to me]

See: Idiom

Amos 9:12 (#2)

נֹאם־יְהוָה עֹשֶׂה זֹאת

“the declaration of Yahweh, the one doing this”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words, is once again interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** and this time adding **the one doing this** to emphasize that what has been said will surely happen as it is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 9:13 (#1)

הַנִּיחַ יָמִימִים בָּאִים־ם

“Behold, days are coming”

Yahweh is using the term **Behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say about **the days** or the specific time that is coming. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention, for the time is coming]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 9:13 (#2)

נֹאֵם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words, is once again interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** to emphasize that what is about to be said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 9:13 (#3)

וְנִגְגַּשׁ חֹרֶשׁ בְּקֹצֵץ וְלֹרֶרֶד עֹנְבֵי־ם בְּמִשְׁשׁוֹ הַזֶּזֶרַע

“and the plower will approach the reaper, and the treader of grapes to the sower of the seed”

The implication is that the harvests will be so large that the plowing and planting seasons will begin before the reaping and the treading of grapes are finished. This was one of the covenant promises mentioned in Leviticus 26:5. You could include this information in a footnote if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 9:13 (#4)

וְלֹרֶרֶד עֹנְבֵי־ם בְּמִשְׁשׁוֹ הַזֶּזֶרַע

“and the treader of grapes to the sower of the seed”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the treader of grapes will approach the sower of the seed]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 9:13 (#5)

וְהִטְטִיפוּ הַהָרִים־ם עֲסֹסִים וְכָל־הַגְּבָעוֹת תִּתְמוֹגְגֶנָּה

“and the mountains will drip sweet wine, and all of the hills will melt”

Yahweh is speaking as if **the mountains** and **the hills** themselves were producing **sweet wine** in such quantity that it flowed down their slopes. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the vineyards on the mountains and the hills will produce great amounts of sweet wine]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:14 (#1)

וְשָׁבְתִי־אֶת־שְׁבָבוֹתַי

“And I will restore the restoration of”

Yahweh is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. This could mean: (1) that he will restore the prosperity of his people as it was before they were exiled, as in the UST, or (2) that he will bring his exiled people back to their land. Alternate translation: [And I will restore from their exile]

See: Poetry

Amos 9:15 (#1)

וְנִטְעַתִּים עַל־אֲדָמָתָם וְלֹא־יִנְתָּשׁוּ עֵדוּד מִצֶּעַל אֲדָמָתָם

“And I will plant them upon their ground, and they will not be uprooted again from upon their ground”

Yahweh is speaking of restoring the Israelites to their land as if they were plants that he would **plant** in the ground that would never be **uprooted** again. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will settle them permanently in their land, and they will not be driven out again from upon the land]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:15 (#2)

וְלֹא־יִנְתָּשׁוּ עֵדוּד מִצֶּעַל אֲדָמָתָם

“and they will not be uprooted again from upon their ground”

The expression **be uprooted** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and no one will uproot them again from upon their ground]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 9:15 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵיךָ

“your God”

Amos is not using this possessive form **your God** to indicate that the Israelites possess or control Yahweh. Rather, he is using these words to remind them that Yahweh is the God who chose them and whom they should worship. Alternate translation: [the God whom you worship]

See: Possession